

ENGLISH FOR SERVICE ADVISORS, TECHNICIANS, AND PARTS TEAMS

Automotive Service English

Accurate concerns. Clear
commitments.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For automotive service advisors, technicians, parts staff, and customer-service teams working with vehicle owners and workshop colleagues.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight service conversations follow the customer journey: capture an intermittent concern, clarify drop-off, confirm assessment scope, brief the technician, explain a parts delay, relay a diagnostic finding, read an invoice, and recover a mishandled repeat complaint.

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Tuesday arrival is not Tuesday collection | Explain a parts delay by separating supplier estimates, shipment confirmation, workshop scheduling, and a firm update commitment.

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A code is a clue, not a replacement order | Translate a diagnostic note into accurate customer language while separating recorded information, confirmed cause, and authorized work.

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Make the next handoff more accurate.

Good service English keeps the vehicle, symptom, permission, price, and promised contact clear. Practice explaining technical information without guessing at a diagnosis or turning an estimate into a guarantee.

Keep the customer concern intact

Record the vehicle, the sound or symptom, its reported location, and when it occurs. A customer description is useful evidence without being a diagnosis. Intermittent does not mean imaginary or constant.

"The blue hatchback has an occasional rear rattle after overnight parking; cause unknown."

Define the commitment

Drop-off is not necessarily the start of workshop work. A status call is not a finish promise. Go ahead needs a precise readback of what the customer is authorizing under the stated shop terms.

"You authorize the \$95 assessment only; any repair proposal needs separate approval."

Separate clues from conclusions

A diagnostic trouble code can guide investigation without proving that a named sensor needs replacement. Relay the technician record and ask for the missing explanation rather than supplying one from assumption.

"The note records a code, but no confirmed cause or component fault."

Repair the conversation as well as the record

When a customer reports a repeat concern, correct an unsupported dismissal. Acknowledge the new report, retain the earlier history, and state the next contact without promising coverage or a technical result.

"I should not have said that was impossible. Nia can call at 15:00 to review your report."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

The vehicles, shop terms, charges, records, and events are fictional. This book teaches English, not vehicle diagnosis, repair, testing, driving decisions, or legal advice. Follow actual training, authorization, manufacturer information, shop procedures, and applicable requirements. A code, invoice, or customer description does not establish vehicle safety, readiness, repair necessity, or warranty coverage. The dialogues give no instructions to reproduce symptoms while driving or work on a vehicle.

The blue hatchback and an occasional rear rattle

A Read the situation

Identify the booked vehicle and capture an intermittent customer concern without inventing its frequency, cause, or technical finding.

Two household cars are listed on the account, but today Mina has booked the blue hatchback. She reports an occasional rattle from the rear after the car has been parked overnight. She does not know the cause, and no technician assessment has occurred. Advisor Ellis must confirm the vehicle, preserve the reported sound and conditions, and read back the concern. Mina is describing existing observations; she is not asked to drive or perform a test to reproduce the sound.

PEOPLE / Mina: Customer | Ellis: Service advisor

CAPTURE THE DESCRIPTION BEFORE TRANSLATING IT INTO WORKSHOP SHORTHAND

A customer can describe a sound accurately without knowing a component name. Confirm the vehicle and repeat the reported conditions. Keep everyday wording when it carries useful meaning, and avoid leading questions that make a suspected part sound like an established fault.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which vehicle is booked today?

- A Both household cars
- B An unspecified workshop loan car
- C The other car by default
- D The blue hatchback

2. How does Mina describe the sound?

- A A continuous engine squeal
- B An occasional rattle from the rear
- C A constant front-end knock
- D A verified brake failure

3. What assessment has occurred?

- A A completed repair verification
- B A finding that the car is fault-free
- C None by a technician yet
- D A confirmed component diagnosis

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service advisor

Staff member coordinating customer communication and workshop work.

IN USE brief the service advisor

customer concern

Issue described by the vehicle owner or user.

IN USE capture the customer concern

vehicle identification

Information establishing which vehicle a record concerns.

IN USE confirm vehicle identification

service interval

Specified time or accumulated-distance basis for scheduled maintenance, subject to the actual vehicle schedule.

IN USE check the service interval

hatchback

Car body style with an upward-opening rear door to the cargo area.

IN USE identify the blue hatchback

booking reference

Identifier for a scheduled service appointment.

IN USE confirm the booking reference

tire aspect ratio

Nominal sidewall height expressed as a percentage of nominal section width in a tire-size designation.

IN USE read the tire aspect ratio

vehicle identification number

Unique vehicle identifier commonly abbreviated VIN.

IN USE confirm the vehicle identification number

load index

Tire rating code associated with load capacity, not a literal weight in kilograms.

IN USE verify the load index

model

Named vehicle design within a manufacturer's range.

IN USE confirm the model

state of charge

Battery charge level expressed as a percentage on the applicable battery system's basis.

IN USE distinguish state of charge from capacity

odometer

Instrument recording accumulated vehicle distance.

IN USE record the odometer reading

Precision check

The booked vehicle is the blue hatchback, not both cars on the account. The sound is occasional and reported from the rear after overnight parking. Do not change those details to a constant noise or a named failed component.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

intermittent

Occurring at intervals rather than continuously.

IN USE describe an intermittent concern

rattle

Repeated light knocking or vibrating sound.

IN USE describe the reported rattle

rear

Part or direction toward the back of the vehicle.

IN USE locate the sound at the rear

overnight parking

Period during which a vehicle remains parked through the night.

IN USE note overnight parking

reported conditions

Circumstances described as accompanying the concern.

IN USE preserve the reported conditions

frequency

How often a symptom is reported to occur.

IN USE clarify the reported frequency

total toe

Combined toe value for the two wheels on an axle under the report's sign convention.

IN USE read total toe

symptom description

Account of the experienced sound, behavior, or condition.

IN USE retain the symptom description

technician assessment

Relevant professional evaluation of the concern.

IN USE distinguish a technician assessment

angular minute

One sixtieth of a degree, not one hundredth of a degree.

IN USE convert angular minutes to decimal degrees

job card

Workshop record containing the requested work and relevant details.

IN USE prepare the job card

concern readback

Repetition of the customer's account to confirm accuracy.

IN USE give a concern readback

Precision check

No technician assessment has occurred. The readback should preserve what Mina has already experienced without asking her to reproduce a symptom while driving or inventing details about speed, exact duration, cause, or vehicle safety.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CONFIRM THE VEHICLE

"Which of the two cars is booked today?"

KEEP THE ACCOUNT SEPARATE

"I will not attach this concern to the other vehicle."

PRESERVE THE SOUND

"You report a rattle from the rear."

CLARIFY THE CONDITION

"You have noticed it after the car was parked overnight."

REPEAT THE SELECTION

"I have the blue hatchback for this appointment."

ASK FOR THE EXISTING DESCRIPTION

"How have you described the sound you noticed?"

PRESERVE FREQUENCY

"It is occasional, not constant."

AVOID INVENTING A CAUSE

"You have not identified what causes it."

Occasional versus constant

Preserves how often the sound is reported without inventing a frequency.

From the rear

Locates the perceived sound without identifying a particular component.

After overnight parking

Records a circumstance, not necessarily a proven cause.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP ASSESSMENT SEPARATE

"No technician assessment has taken place yet."

KEEP THE RECORD ATTRIBUTED

"The customer reports the following concern."

DISTINGUISH IDENTITY FIELDS

"A model name and a vehicle identification number are different."

GIVE THE COMPLETE READBACK

"Blue hatchback; occasional rear rattle after overnight parking; cause unknown."

AVOID LEADING TERMINOLOGY

"I will record rattle without naming a failed component."

AVOID A FALSE GUARANTEE

"This description does not establish whether the vehicle is fault-free."

ASK FOR CONFIRMATION

"Does that wording accurately describe your experience?"

CLOSE WITH THE HANDOFF

"I will put that concern on the job card for assessment."

Customer reports

Separates the account from a technician finding.

Has not taken place yet

Identifies the current assessment stage.

Does that wording ...?

Invites a bounded accuracy check instead of a request to diagnose the vehicle.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which job-card wording preserves the account?

- A** Customer reports occasional rear rattle after overnight parking in blue hatchback
- B** Technician confirmed rear suspension failure
- C** Both cars have constant engine noise
- D** Customer proved the vehicle is safe

2. Which question is leading?

- A** Does this readback match what you noticed?
- B** Which rear component has failed?
- C** Which car is booked today?
- D** Is the sound occasional or constant in your account?

3. What should Ellis not add?

- A** The blue hatchback
- B** The rear location
- C** Overnight parking
- D** A precise cause or unreported driving condition

4. Why should the vehicle be confirmed first?

- A** The booking identifies a failed sensor
- B** Two cars are on the account and only one is booked
- C** Color proves the mechanical cause
- D** Both cars must receive the same repair

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The blue hatchback and an occasional rear rattle

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

concern readback / vehicle identification / booking reference / job card / frequency / reported conditions / customer concern / technician assessment / symptom description / intermittent

- 01 **Mina:** I've booked the blue hatchback for a rattle. There are two cars on our account; could you check which one you've opened?
- 02 **Ellis:** Certainly. Let us confirm the ¹ _____ first. Which of the two cars is booked for today's appointment?
- 03 **Mina:** Yes, the blue hatchback. Today's concern isn't about the other car.
- 04 **Ellis:** I will keep the ² _____ with the blue hatchback and make sure the concern is recorded there. How would you describe the sound you have noticed?
- 05 **Mina:** It's an occasional rattle from the rear. I've noticed it after the car's been parked overnight.
- 06 **Ellis:** I will record an ³ _____ rattle from the rear after overnight parking. In this context, intermittent means occasional rather than continuous; is that consistent with your experience?
- 07 **Mina:** Occasional is right. I can't tell you how many times, and I wouldn't say it happens every morning.
- 08 **Ellis:** Then we will preserve the reported ⁴ _____ as occasional, without inventing a count. The technician should receive what you know, not a more definite pattern than you described.
- 09 **Mina:** Rear is as specific as I can be. I don't know which part is making it.
- 10 **Ellis:** That is enough for the ⁵ _____. We can keep rear as the reported location without turning it into a claim that a particular component has failed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Mina:** Nobody's assessed it yet. I don't want my guess written down as a diagnosis.
- 12 **Ellis:** I will make that stage clear. No ⁶ _____ has taken place, and the cause is unknown. The record will not present your description as a workshop finding.
- 13 **Mina:** Please keep after overnight parking in the note. I don't know whether that's the cause, but it's when I've noticed it.
- 14 **Ellis:** Agreed. Those are ⁷ _____, not an established explanation. I will not add a speed, journey length, or other circumstance that you have not supplied.
- 15 **Mina:** Will those details reach the technician? I don't want the job card to end up saying only noisy car.
- 16 **Ellis:** That helps us produce a useful ⁸ _____. Ordinary words such as rattle can carry important detail when the vehicle, location, and circumstances are accurately recorded.
- 17 **Mina:** Yes, that readback matches. No fixed frequency, and no part identified.
- 18 **Ellis:** Here is the ⁹ _____: customer reports an occasional rear rattle in the blue hatchback after overnight parking. Cause unknown; no technician assessment has occurred.
- 19 **Mina:** Thank you. That's what I wanted recorded, without making the sound seem constant.
- 20 **Ellis:** I will retain that ¹⁰ _____ for the workshop handoff. The next assessment can build on an accurate description instead of starting from an assumed cause.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. vehicle identification | 2. booking reference | 3. intermittent | 4. frequency | 5. symptom description | 6. technician assessment | 7. reported conditions | 8. job card | 9. concern readback | 10. customer concern

Read back the booked concern

F Say it

Complete the intake summary. Preserve the correct car, sound, location, and reported condition.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rear / hatchback / rattle / overnight

Advisor: "The booked vehicle is the blue ¹ _____."

Customer: "I report an occasional ² _____."

Advisor: "You hear it from the ³ _____."

Customer: "I have noticed it after ⁴ _____ parking."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. hatchback | 2. rattle | 3. rear | 4. overnight

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the concern in the brief, then complete the dialogue using the supplied word bank.
2. Read Mina's turns aloud, stressing occasional, rear, and after overnight parking. Then read Ellis's matching readback.
3. Complete the four-line transfer and check each answer against the explained key. Keep the vehicle and reported conditions unchanged.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eight is intake, ten is an update

A Read the situation

Correct an appointment misunderstanding with a specific communication promise while keeping workshop start and completion times unconfirmed.

Customer Omar has booked an 08:00 drop-off and expects work to start immediately and finish by 09:00. The booking confirms intake only. Advisor Leila can offer a status update by 10:00, not a completion guarantee. Omar prefers a phone call. Leila must explain the distinction, acknowledge the timing expectation, and record the call preference. No technician start slot, repair duration, or collection time has been confirmed.

PEOPLE / Omar: Customer | Leila: Service advisor

REPLACE A MISTAKEN PROMISE WITH A REAL ONE

A customer who hears appointment may imagine a dedicated work slot. Explain the actual booking without blaming the customer. A specific update time and preferred contact method create a useful commitment while leaving unconfirmed completion information honest.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does 08:00 confirm?

- A Vehicle completion
- B A confirmed one-hour repair
- C Intake at drop-off
- D Technician work starting immediately

2. What can Leila promise?

- A Immediate technician attention
- B A collection slot at 10:00
- C A status update by 10:00
- D Completion by 09:00

3. How does Omar prefer to receive the update?

- A By assuming silence means completion
- B By phone call
- C Only by email
- D Through an unconfirmed third party

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

drop-off

Delivery of a vehicle to the service location.

IN USE confirm the drop-off time

intake

Initial process of receiving the vehicle and recording the request.

IN USE distinguish intake from workshop work

appointment

Arranged time for the stated service interaction.

IN USE clarify what the appointment covers

workshop start

Point when the assigned technical work begins.

IN USE confirm the workshop start

technician slot

Scheduled period assigned to a technician for work.

IN USE verify the technician slot

completion time

Time when the defined work is expected or confirmed to finish.

IN USE distinguish completion time

collection time

Time agreed for the customer to receive the vehicle.

IN USE confirm the collection time

status update

Communication reporting the current position of the work.

IN USE provide a status update

update deadline

Latest time promised for further information.

IN USE meet the update deadline

phone preference

Customer choice to receive communication by telephone.

IN USE record the phone preference

contact method

Means used to communicate with the customer.

IN USE confirm the contact method

callback number

Number agreed for a return telephone call.

IN USE verify the callback number

Precision check

An 08:00 drop-off is not a confirmed 08:00 technician start. Nothing establishes completion by 09:00. Preserve the booked intake while correcting the unsupported assumptions about work and turnaround.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

booking terms

Stated conditions defining what an appointment includes.

IN USE clarify the booking terms

timing expectation

Customer understanding of when something will happen.

IN USE acknowledge the timing expectation

turnaround

Time between receiving work and returning the completed item.

IN USE avoid promising an unverified turnaround

work queue

Ordered or managed set of jobs awaiting attention.

IN USE distinguish the work queue

progress report

Account of how far the work has advanced.

IN USE give a progress report

estimated finish

Provisional prediction of completion time.

IN USE qualify the estimated finish

confirmed finish

Completion time explicitly established through the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed finish

waiting appointment

Booking specifically arranged for a customer to wait under stated terms.

IN USE verify a waiting appointment

transport arrangement

Plan for the customer's travel while the vehicle is at the shop.

IN USE discuss a transport arrangement

availability window

Period when a person can be contacted or attend.

IN USE record the availability window

schedule clarification

Correction of an ambiguous or mistaken timing understanding.

IN USE give a schedule clarification

commitment readback

Repetition of agreed promises and their limits.

IN USE give a commitment readback

Precision check

By 10:00 is an update deadline, not a vehicle-ready time. The promised contact is a phone call. Do not relabel the appointment as a waiting service or invent collection, transport, or workshop arrangements.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXPECTATION

"I understand that you expected the work to start at eight."

SEPARATE THE WORK SLOT

"It does not confirm an 08:00 technician start."

OFFER A REAL COMMITMENT

"I can provide a status update by 10:00."

CONFIRM THE PREFERENCE

"You would prefer a phone call."

CLARIFY THE BOOKING

"The 08:00 booking is for drop-off intake."

AVOID A ONE-HOUR PROMISE

"Completion by 09:00 has not been confirmed."

NAME THE COMMUNICATION

"That is an update, not a finish guarantee."

RECORD THE METHOD

"I will keep phone as the contact method."

For drop-off

Defines the event covered by the appointment.

Does not confirm

Limits the inference without canceling the actual booking.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a particular time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP COLLECTION SEPARATE

"We still need actual confirmation before giving a collection time."

USE THE DEADLINE ACCURATELY

"By ten means no later than ten for the update."

AVOID ASSUMING TRANSPORT

"We have not agreed a separate transport arrangement here."

READ BACK THE COMMITMENTS

"Drop-off at eight; phone update by ten; finish time unconfirmed."

AVOID INVENTING A WAITING BOOKING

"This record does not confirm a waiting appointment."

PRESERVE THE INTAKE TIME

"Your drop-off booking remains at 08:00."

GIVE AN HONEST LIMIT

"I cannot promise a work duration that has not been established."

CLOSE WITH CLARITY

"I will keep those three points separate in the booking notes."

Update, not finish

Prevents a communication promise from becoming a completion guarantee.

Would prefer

Records the customer's chosen communication method.

Remains

Preserves the valid booking while correcting its misinterpretation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement best corrects Omar's expectation?

- A** The update at ten guarantees collection at ten
- B** Drop-off and technician start always mean the same thing
- C** Eight is drop-off intake; start and finish are not confirmed
- D** All eight o'clock bookings finish at nine

2. What does by 10:00 mean here?

- A** No update is needed until the next day
- B** The status call will be provided no later than 10:00
- C** The repair must finish exactly at 10:00
- D** The car can be collected before 10:00

3. Which detail belongs in the contact notes?

- A** Customer can infer completion from silence
- B** Phone call preferred
- C** Email only despite the request
- D** No contact method needed

4. Which promise exceeds Leila's stated authority?

- A** The booking is for intake
- B** I will note your phone preference
- C** The car will definitely be ready by 09:00
- D** I can update you by 10:00

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

Eight is intake, ten is an update

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

status update / contact method / waiting appointment / intake / drop-off / phone preference / commitment readback / update deadline / completion time / collection time

- 01 **Omar:** I'm dropping it off at eight. Can I wait and collect it at nine? I thought eight was when the technician would start.
- 02 **Leila:** I understand. I need to clarify that the booking is for ¹ _____ at 08:00. It does not confirm an eight o'clock technician start or a nine o'clock finish.
- 03 **Omar:** I see. I had treated the drop-off time as the start of the work.
- 04 **Leila:** Eight is the ² _____ time for receiving the vehicle and the service request. The technical start and duration have not been confirmed in this booking.
- 05 **Omar:** Then nine isn't confirmed either. I need to know that before I arrange the rest of my morning.
- 06 **Leila:** That is important. We do not have a confirmed ³ _____, so I should not repeat your nine o'clock expectation as though it were a promise from the workshop.
- 07 **Omar:** What can you commit to today, even if you can't give me a collection time yet?
- 08 **Leila:** I can give you a ⁴ _____ by 10:00. That will report the position at that stage; it is not a guarantee that the vehicle will be ready then.
- 09 **Omar:** By ten, rather than at ten exactly? I don't want to miss the call because I've assumed a fixed time.
- 10 **Leila:** I will record that ⁵ _____. The promised update will be by phone, using the agreed contact details in your booking.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Omar:** Phone is best. Please keep that with the update deadline.
- 12 **Leila:** Yes. Ten is the ⁶ _____, not a fixed completion appointment. Keeping those separate should make the booking notes and your expectations consistent.
- 13 **Omar:** So I shouldn't tell someone I'm booked to wait here while it's done.
- 14 **Leila:** Correct. A ⁷ _____ is not confirmed here. We should not add that assumption merely because you initially hoped to stay for an hour.
- 15 **Omar:** And nothing has been agreed about a lift or other transport. I'll keep that separate.
- 16 **Leila:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ remains unconfirmed. A communication promise helps you plan the next decision, but it does not itself establish that the vehicle can be handed back.
- 17 **Omar:** Could you read back what is actually booked, without the nine o'clock assumption?
- 18 **Leila:** I will keep the ⁹ _____ alongside the deadline. The handoff should say phone update by 10:00, not simply contact customer when convenient.
- 19 **Omar:** Understood: drop-off at eight, phone update by ten, no confirmed finish or collection time.
- 20 **Leila:** That ¹⁰ _____ is accurate. I will record it that way so the next colleague sees what is booked, what is promised, and what still needs confirmation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. drop-off | 2. intake | 3. completion time | 4. status update | 5. phone preference | 6. update deadline | 7. waiting appointment | 8. collection time | 9. contact method | 10. commitment readback

Confirm the appointment without a finish promise

F Say it

Complete the booking readback. Keep intake, communication, and completion distinct.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

10:00 / 08:00 / phone / unconfirmed

Advisor: "Drop-off intake is booked for ¹ _____."

Customer: "I prefer a ² _____ call."

Advisor: "The status update will be provided by ³ _____."

Customer: "The finish time remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. 08:00 | 2. phone | 3. 10:00 | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the dialogue, distinguishing drop-off, workshop start, update, and collection.
2. Read the time exchanges aloud: eight for drop-off, by ten for the phone update, nine not confirmed. Switch roles and repeat.
3. Complete the transfer. Check whether each time names an appointment, a deadline, or an unconfirmed expectation.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Go ahead with the assessment only

A Read the situation

03

Resolve ambiguous approval by reading back the exact service, charge, and limit, then separate any later repair decision.

A fictional shop offers an assessment for \$95 under its stated booking terms. No repair is included. Customer Hana says go ahead, intending only the assessment, while advisor Dev needs to record the authorization accurately. Dev must read back the \$95 assessment-only scope and route any later repair proposal for separate approval. No repair price, component replacement, or guaranteed diagnostic outcome is supplied. The terms belong to this fictional booking, not to every repair shop.

PEOPLE / Hana: Customer | Dev: Service advisor

CONFIRM THE MEANING OF A SHORT YES

A brief go ahead can conceal different assumptions about scope. Read back the service and charge in one sentence, then state what is not included. The aim is a shared record of the actual decision, not pressure to approve an unspecified repair.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the \$95 cover in this booking?

- A Assessment plus any needed repair
- C All future visits

- B A guaranteed replacement sensor
- D Assessment only

2. What does Hana intend by go ahead?

- A Acceptance of a guaranteed diagnosis
- C Approval of every later repair

- B Permission for the assessment only
- D Agreement to an unknown repair price

3. What must happen with a later repair proposal?

- A It needs separate approval
- C It can proceed without being described

- B It is automatically covered by the initial yes
- D It must be free regardless of scope

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assessment fee

Charge for the defined evaluation service.

IN USE explain the assessment fee

diagnostic time

Time spent investigating a reported vehicle concern.

IN USE distinguish diagnostic time

assessment scope

Work included in the agreed evaluation.

IN USE confirm the assessment scope

repair scope

Defined corrective work proposed or authorized.

IN USE separate the repair scope

authorization

Permission for a specific action or service.

IN USE record the authorization

approval limit

Boundary of what the customer has agreed to.

IN USE preserve the approval limit

assessment only

Wording excluding repair from the current approval.

IN USE state assessment only

repair proposal

Description of suggested corrective work and its relevant terms.

IN USE present the repair proposal

separate approval

New permission for work outside the current authorization.

IN USE obtain separate approval

written estimate

Document describing expected cost for defined work.

IN USE review the written estimate

itemized quote

Price proposal separating relevant components of cost.

IN USE provide an itemized quote

parts charge

Cost associated with supplied components.

IN USE identify the parts charge

Precision check

The fictional booking offers a \$95 assessment, with no repair included. Hana intends to approve that service only. The phrase go ahead must not expand into permission for an undefined repair or component replacement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

labor charge

Cost associated with the stated work time or labor provision.

IN USE distinguish the labor charge

scope readback

Repetition of the exact work covered by permission.

IN USE give a scope readback

stated terms

Conditions explicitly supplied for the booking or service.

IN USE follow the stated terms

cost commitment

Agreed financial obligation for defined work.

IN USE clarify the cost commitment

additional work

Work beyond the already authorized scope.

IN USE seek approval for additional work

component replacement

Removal and substitution of a particular vehicle part.

IN USE propose component replacement

diagnostic outcome

Result of the assessment, which may include unresolved questions.

IN USE avoid guaranteeing a diagnostic outcome

customer consent

Customer agreement to the identified work and terms.

IN USE confirm customer consent

approval record

Documentation of the permission actually given.

IN USE update the approval record

unpriced repair

Corrective work for which a price has not been supplied.

IN USE distinguish an unpriced repair

service inclusion

Item expressly covered in the described service.

IN USE confirm service inclusions

decision boundary

Limit between the present agreement and a later required decision.

IN USE explain the decision boundary

Precision check

Any later repair proposal requires separate approval under the supplied terms. The assessment fee does not establish a repair price or guarantee a particular diagnostic outcome. Keep the present cost and later decision separate.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

NAME THE PRESENT SERVICE

"The \$95 charge is for the assessment."

CLARIFY THE SHORT APPROVAL

"By go ahead, do you mean the assessment only?"

PRESERVE THE SCOPE

"I will record assessment only."

AVOID AN AUTOMATIC EXTENSION

"Your current yes does not authorize unspecified repairs."

STATE THE LIMIT

"No repair is included in that amount."

READ BACK THE CHARGE

"You are authorizing the \$95 assessment."

SEPARATE LATER WORK

"Any later repair proposal will need separate approval."

AVOID A FALSE INCLUSION

"The assessment charge is not a repair package."

For the assessment

Attaches the price to one defined service.

Only

Restricts authorization rather than merely emphasizing the service name.

By go ahead, do you mean ...?

Checks the intended meaning of an ambiguous phrase.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

KEEP THE OUTCOME OPEN

"We have not guaranteed a particular diagnostic result."

ASK FOR CONFIRMATION

"Does that match the permission you intend to give?"

KEEP COMPONENTS UNAPPROVED

"No component replacement is authorized by this assessment approval."

RECORD THE AGREEMENT

"The approval record will show the service, amount, and limit."

KEEP THE REPAIR PRICE OPEN

"No repair price has been supplied yet."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT DECISION

"We will explain any proposed repair before seeking its approval."

USE THE ACTUAL TERMS

"These are the stated terms for this booking."

CLOSE WITHOUT PRESSURE

"The later repair decision remains separate from today's assessment."

Any later

Keeps a future proposal conditional rather than inevitable.

Not included

Identifies a scope boundary without inventing another price.

Separate from

Prevents present consent from silently authorizing later work.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which readback is most accurate?

- A** Go ahead means we may replace any component
- B** You authorize the \$95 assessment only; repair needs separate approval
- C** You approve assessment and all repairs
- D** Ninety-five dollars guarantees a complete repair

2. What should Dev avoid promising?

- A** The assessment charge stated in the booking
- B** A clear approval record
- C** A separate later repair decision
- D** A particular diagnostic result or unpriced repair

3. What makes the original go ahead ambiguous?

- A** It does not itself state the exact approved scope
- B** It always means refusal
- C** It is a technical vehicle identifier
- D** It establishes every repair cost

4. Which item belongs in the approval record?

- A** Unlimited additional work
- B** Assessment only, \$95, with repair excluded
- C** A guessed replacement part
- D** A promised free repair

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Go ahead with the assessment only

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval limit / separate approval / assessment fee / repair proposal / assessment scope / customer consent / approval record / component replacement / diagnostic outcome / scope readback

- 01 **Hana:** Go ahead with the ninety-five dollars. But before you put that through, is that just looking at the problem, or does it include fixing it?
- 02 **Dev:** It's assessment only. I'll record the ¹ _____ with the price so there's no suggestion that a repair is included.
- 03 **Hana:** Then please don't put just customer says go ahead. Someone else could read that as permission to fit whatever part they find.
- 04 **Dev:** Agreed. The ² _____ is the \$95 assessment, with no corrective work approved. I'll put that in the workshop instruction.
- 05 **Hana:** Is ninety-five a deposit against a repair, then? I had understood it as a charge for finding out what's wrong.
- 06 **Dev:** Here it's the ³ _____ for the evaluation, not a repair allowance. We haven't agreed any later repair price.
- 07 **Hana:** And if the assessment doesn't identify one definite faulty part, does that mean you haven't done what I've paid for?
- 08 **Dev:** We haven't guaranteed a particular ⁴ _____. The authorized service is the assessment; I shouldn't promise a specific finding before it happens.
- 09 **Hana:** All right. Suppose the technician recommends work. I want to hear what it is and what it costs before deciding.
- 10 **Dev:** We'll bring any ⁵ _____ back to you as a separate decision. Today's approval doesn't settle that work or its price.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Hana:** Even a replacement that seems obvious to the technician? I don't want obvious to become already ordered on my behalf.
- 12 **Dev:** No ⁶ _____ is authorized under this agreement. A likely recommendation still isn't your permission to carry it out.
- 13 **Hana:** Can you make that visible to the next advisor? I may not speak to you when the assessment comes back.
- 14 **Dev:** Yes. The note will require ⁷ _____ for any repair, so the handover doesn't depend on someone remembering this conversation.
- 15 **Hana:** Please read that line to me before we finish. I'd like the price and the limit together.
- 16 **Dev:** My ⁸ _____ is: you authorize the \$95 assessment only; no repair is included or approved. Any later repair proposal requires another decision from you.
- 17 **Hana:** Yes, that's what I'm agreeing to. Not an open-ended repair, and not a promise that the assessment finds a particular failed part.
- 18 **Dev:** I'll attach that ⁹ _____ to this booking, with the assessment-only scope. It won't carry forward as approval for future work.
- 19 **Hana:** Thank you. Go ahead with the assessment on those terms, and come back to me about anything beyond it.
- 20 **Dev:** I'll complete the ¹⁰ _____ now: assessment, \$95, no repair included. The workshop and the next advisor will receive the same instruction.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. assessment scope | 2. approval limit | 3. assessment fee | 4. diagnostic outcome | 5. repair proposal | 6. component replacement | 7. separate approval | 8. scope readback | 9. customer consent | 10. approval record

Read back the exact approval

F Say it

Complete the authorization record using the fictional booking terms. Do not add an unpriced repair.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

95 / separate / repair / assessment

Advisor: "The authorized charge is ¹ _____ dollars."

Customer: "I approve the ² _____ only."

Advisor: "No ³ _____ is included or approved."

Customer: "Any later proposal needs ⁴ _____ approval."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 95 | 2. assessment | 3. repair | 4. separate

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the dialogue with the assessment and approval terms.
2. Read the approval exchange aloud. Include \$95, assessment only, repair excluded, and separate approval without dropping any part.
3. Complete the transfer, check the key, and reread the corrected approval in full.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Job 208: keep the concern and contact limits together

A Read the situation

04

Deliver a concise internal handoff that preserves the symptom, assessment-only authorization, reproduction status, and customer contact window.

Job card 208 records a customer-reported intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking. The customer has approved assessment only, is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00, and prefers a phone call after 14:00. Technician Arun has not reproduced the concern. Advisor Rosa hands over these facts without naming a cause, expanding authorization, or treating non-reproduction as proof that nothing is wrong. The agreed contact window must remain visible with the technical request.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Service advisor | Arun: Technician

TREAT CONTACT DETAILS AS PART OF A TECHNICAL HANDOFF

A workshop handoff can fail even when the symptom is described accurately if the approval limit or customer availability is lost. Put the job identifier first, separate reported and observed information, then read back permission and contact constraints before ending the exchange.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which job is being handed over?

A Job card 208

C An unidentified household account

B Job card 315

D A completed invoice only

2. What is the authorization?

A Any work while the customer is unavailable

C Unlimited repair

B Assessment only

D An approved replacement

3. What contact arrangement is supplied?

A Call during the unavailable period

C No need to contact the customer

B Email only before noon

D Phone call after 14:00; unavailable 12:00-14:00

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

internal handoff

Transfer of relevant information between colleagues.

IN USE give an internal handoff

job identifier

Number or code distinguishing a workshop record.

IN USE state the job identifier

cabin

Interior space used by vehicle occupants.

IN USE locate the cabin concern

intermittent rattle

Occasional repeated light knocking or vibrating sound.

IN USE retain the intermittent rattle description

customer-reported

Attributed to the customer's account rather than a technician finding.

IN USE label the concern customer-reported

reproduced concern

Reported condition observed again during relevant assessment.

IN USE record whether the concern was reproduced

not reproduced

Wording stating that the reported condition has not been observed during the assessment.

IN USE retain not-reproduced status

assessment authorization

Permission for the defined evaluation work.

IN USE confirm assessment authorization

repair authorization

Permission for specified corrective work.

IN USE distinguish repair authorization

contact window

Period when customer communication is appropriate under the stated arrangement.

IN USE preserve the contact window

unavailable interval

Period during which the customer cannot be reached as arranged.

IN USE record the unavailable interval

preferred channel

Communication method selected by the customer.

IN USE preserve the preferred channel

Precision check

Job 208 concerns a customer-reported cabin rattle after overnight parking. Arun has not reproduced it. Non-reproduction is a limited observation, not proof that the report was mistaken or that a cause has been found.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

workshop handover

Exchange passing a job and its relevant context to the workshop.

IN USE complete the workshop handover

finding status

Current state of observed or established results.

IN USE clarify the finding status

diagnostic hypothesis

Possible explanation requiring relevant investigation.

IN USE distinguish a diagnostic hypothesis

confirmed cause

Explanation established by the relevant assessment.

IN USE avoid inventing a confirmed cause

noise concern

Customer report about an unwanted vehicle sound.

IN USE describe the noise concern

reported trigger

Circumstance the customer associates with the symptom.

IN USE preserve the reported trigger

concern history

Record of earlier descriptions or occurrences.

IN USE retain the concern history

contact note

Record of communication preferences or restrictions.

IN USE include the contact note

authorization boundary

Limit of work for which permission has been given.

IN USE state the authorization boundary

handoff readback

Repetition by the receiving person of the essential information.

IN USE request a handoff readback

non-reproduction

Absence of the reported symptom during the relevant assessment.

IN USE distinguish non-reproduction from resolution

next communication

Following planned exchange with the customer.

IN USE plan the next communication

Precision check

Assessment-only approval remains in force while the customer is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00. That interval does not permit extra work. The preferred next contact is a phone call after 14:00, not an invented fixed appointment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN WITH THE IDENTIFIER

"This handoff is for job card 208."

PRESERVE THE CONDITION

"They associate it with overnight parking."

AVOID DISMISSING THE ACCOUNT

"Not reproduced does not mean the report is false."

STATE THE PERMISSION

"The authorization is for assessment only."

STATE THE CUSTOMER'S CONCERN

"The customer reports an intermittent cabin rattle."

STATE THE ASSESSMENT LIMIT

"You have not reproduced the concern."

KEEP CAUSE OPEN

"No confirmed cause is supplied."

EXCLUDE ASSUMED EXTRA WORK

"No repair authorization is recorded."

Customer reports

Preserves attribution when the technician has not observed the concern.

Not reproduced

Describes an assessment limit without dismissing an intermittent report.

After versus at

Distinguishes a time window from an exact appointment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

GIVE THE UNAVAILABLE INTERVAL

"The customer is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00."

AVOID AN EXACT-TIME INVENTION

"After two is a window, not a confirmed call at exactly two."

KEEP THE CHANNEL VISIBLE

"Please retain phone as the preferred channel."

KEEP OBSERVATIONS ATTRIBUTED

"Separate the customer report from what you have observed."

GIVE THE PREFERRED CONTACT

"They prefer a phone call after 14:00."

KEEP PERMISSION UNCHANGED

"Being unable to reach the customer does not expand the scope."

REQUEST THE RECEIVER'S CHECK

"Can you read back the concern, scope, and contact window?"

CLOSE WITH A COMPLETE HANDOFF

"Job 208, assessment only, concern not reproduced, phone after 14:00."

Unavailable from ... to

States both endpoints of the contact restriction.

Does not expand

Keeps permission unchanged despite a communication difficulty.

Concern, scope, contact

Groups three different kinds of essential handoff information.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff preserves all critical facts?

- A** Job 208: confirmed fault repaired; call at noon
- B** Job 315: unlimited repairs; email whenever convenient
- C** Job 208: no problem exists because no noise was heard
- D** Job 208: intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking; assessment only; not reproduced; phone after 14:00

2. What does not reproduced mean here?

- A** The fault has been repaired
- B** The cause is confirmed
- C** Arun has not observed the reported concern during assessment
- D** The customer invented the sound

3. When should the preferred phone contact occur?

- A** Exactly 12:00 regardless of availability
- B** Only by email before 14:00
- C** After 14:00, outside the stated unavailable interval
- D** Between 12:00 and 14:00

4. What changes the approval limit during customer unavailability?

- A** The inability to contact them automatically permits repair
- B** The job number authorizes replacement
- C** Non-reproduction grants unlimited work
- D** Nothing in these facts

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Job 208: keep the concern and contact limits together

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Repair authorization / Non-reproduction / preferred channel / confirmed cause / contact window / authorization boundary / customer-reported / job identifier / unavailable interval / handoff readback

- 01 **Rosa:** Arun, can we check 208 before I call the customer? The desk needs your result and the contact restriction, not just rattle checked.
- 02 **Arun:** Yes, the ¹ _____ is 208. Is this the intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking?
- 03 **Rosa:** That's the customer's description. Did you reproduce it, or is that still open?
- 04 **Arun:** It's still ² _____. I haven't reproduced the concern, and I don't have a confirmed component diagnosis to add.
- 05 **Rosa:** Then I shouldn't tell them nothing is wrong. They were quite clear that it doesn't happen every time.
- 06 **Arun:** Correct. ³ _____ means I haven't observed it in this assessment. It doesn't prove the sound never occurs or that we've repaired it.
- 07 **Rosa:** Have you done any repair work? The customer approved assessment only, and that's what I have on the desk record.
- 08 **Arun:** That ⁴ _____ hasn't changed. There's no approved corrective work, and a possible next step wouldn't create permission to do it.
- 09 **Rosa:** They're unavailable from noon until two. Please keep that beside the assessment result so nobody tries to contact them in that interval.
- 10 **Arun:** I'll retain the ⁵ _____ as 12:00-14:00. The result and that restriction will go back together.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Rosa:** They asked for a phone call after two. I haven't promised a call at two exactly.
- 12 **Arun:** Understood. The ⁶ _____ is after 14:00, not a fixed 14:00 appointment. I'll keep the wording as supplied.
- 13 **Rosa:** The note currently says contact later. Can you include phone? An email wouldn't match their preference.
- 14 **Arun:** Yes, phone is the ⁷ _____. I'll include both the method and the after-two window in the return note.
- 15 **Rosa:** And if we can't reach them, assessment-only still applies. I don't want silence treated as a yes to repair.
- 16 **Arun:** Agreed. ⁸ _____ is absent. Difficulty reaching the customer doesn't extend the work they've approved.
- 17 **Rosa:** Give me the whole handoff once, please, so I can check it against the desk entry.
- 18 **Arun:** Job 208: intermittent cabin rattle reported after overnight parking, not reproduced, no ⁹ _____. Assessment only; unavailable 12:00-14:00; phone preferred after 14:00.
- 19 **Rosa:** That matches. I'll use not reproduced, not no fault exists, and won't turn the contact window into a promised appointment.
- 20 **Arun:** I'll save that ¹⁰ _____ with the job. You can use the same facts without filling in a cause, repair, or call time we haven't established.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. job identifier | 2. customer-reported | 3. Non-reproduction | 4. authorization boundary | 5. unavailable interval | 6. contact window | 7. preferred channel | 8. Repair authorization | 9. confirmed cause | 10. handoff readback

Pass on the concern, scope, and contact

F Say it

Complete the internal handoff. Keep the job identifier and contact window attached to the assessment-only scope.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assessment / 208 / 14:00 / phone

Advisor: "This is job card ¹ _____."

Technician: "The approval covers ² _____ only."

Advisor: "The customer is unavailable from 12:00 to ³ _____."

Technician: "They prefer a ⁴ _____ call afterward."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 208 | 2. assessment | 3. 14:00 | 4. phone

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the workshop handoff using the supplied terms.
2. Read the handoff aloud, preserving not reproduced, assessment only, unavailable 12:00-14:00, and phone after 14:00.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the handoff without turning after two into at two.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Tuesday arrival is not Tuesday collection

A Read the situation

05

Explain a parts delay by separating supplier estimates, shipment confirmation, workshop scheduling, and a firm update commitment.

The part required for job 315 is on back order. The supplier estimates arrival on Tuesday, but shipment is not confirmed. Customer Ben wants to collect the vehicle on Tuesday. Technician scheduling and completion are also unconfirmed. Parts clerk Nia promises a supply-status update on Monday afternoon. She must acknowledge the requested pickup without accepting it, preserve the supplier estimate as provisional, and avoid treating part arrival as a completed repair.

PEOPLE / Ben: Customer | Nia: Parts clerk

GIVE THE DEPENDENCY CHAIN IN ORDINARY LANGUAGE

A customer may hear a part date as a vehicle-ready date. Separate supply, delivery, workshop work, and collection in a short sequence. Preserve the useful supplier estimate but label it honestly, then give a definite communication commitment that does not depend on a guessed result.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the part's current status?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Delivered and installed | B Confirmed dispatched yesterday |
| C Available for immediate collection with the vehicle | D On back order with shipment unconfirmed |

2. What does Tuesday represent?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A A confirmed technician completion | B A completed installation date |
| C The supplier's estimated arrival | D A guaranteed vehicle pickup |

3. What does Nia promise?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A A guaranteed Monday shipment | B A free replacement vehicle |
| C A supply-status update Monday afternoon | D Vehicle ready Tuesday morning |

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

back order

Order for an item not currently available for immediate supply.

IN USE confirm back-order status

supplier estimate

Provisional timing or quantity information given by the supplier.

IN USE qualify the supplier estimate

estimated arrival

Expected delivery time not necessarily confirmed.

IN USE state the estimated arrival

shipment confirmation

Evidence that goods have been dispatched under the stated arrangement.

IN USE await shipment confirmation

dispatch

Sending goods from the supplier or distribution point.

IN USE distinguish dispatch from arrival

delivery

Transfer of goods to the destination.

IN USE confirm delivery

lead time

Time between an order stage and the relevant supply stage.

IN USE clarify the lead time

parts availability

Whether the required item can be supplied at the relevant time.

IN USE check parts availability

part allocation

Assignment of available stock to a particular order or job.

IN USE verify part allocation

order status

Current position of a purchase or supply request.

IN USE update the order status

supply-status update

Communication about progress or uncertainty in obtaining an item.

IN USE provide a supply-status update

workshop scheduling

Assignment of technical work to available time and staff.

IN USE confirm workshop scheduling

Precision check

Tuesday is the supplier estimate for part arrival. Shipment is unconfirmed, and the part is on back order. Keep the estimate provisional rather than changing it to a guaranteed delivery or a booked collection.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

installation

Fitting the relevant component as part of authorized work.

IN USE distinguish installation from delivery

completion confirmation

Verified statement that the relevant work has finished.

IN USE obtain completion confirmation

pickup request

Customer preference for collecting the vehicle at a stated time.

IN USE record the pickup request

collection commitment

Agreed promise about when the vehicle can be handed over.

IN USE distinguish a collection commitment

dependency

Prior condition on which a later stage relies.

IN USE explain the dependency

provisional date

Date subject to confirmation or change.

IN USE retain the provisional date

confirmed date

Date established through the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed date

parts clerk

Staff member coordinating component identification and supply.

IN USE contact the parts clerk

delay notice

Communication explaining a change or uncertainty in timing.

IN USE give a delay notice

supplier follow-up

Further contact to clarify supply information.

IN USE arrange supplier follow-up

progress checkpoint

Agreed point for reviewing and communicating status.

IN USE set a progress checkpoint

uncertain completion

Finish status or timing that has not been established.

IN USE explain uncertain completion

Precision check

Even part arrival would not by itself confirm technician scheduling, installation, or completion. Nia promises a Monday-afternoon supply update. Ben requests Tuesday pickup, but that request has not been accepted as a commitment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE CURRENT SUPPLY POSITION

"The part for job 315 is on back order."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"Shipment has not been confirmed."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"I understand that you would like Tuesday pickup."

NAME THE NEXT DEPENDENCY

"Technician scheduling still needs confirmation."

ATTRIBUTE THE DATE

"The supplier estimates arrival on Tuesday."

SEPARATE DISPATCH AND ARRIVAL

"A dispatch confirmation would not itself mean the part has arrived."

AVOID ACCEPTING THE DATE

"I cannot confirm Tuesday collection from the current information."

KEEP COMPLETION SEPARATE

"Part arrival is not the same as completed work."

Supplier estimates

Attributes a provisional date to its actual source.

Would like

Records a customer preference without accepting it as agreed.

Not the same as

Separates supply stages from workshop completion.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

GIVE THE FIRM UPDATE

"I will update you on supply status Monday afternoon."

AVOID INVENTING ALLOCATION

"We have no confirmed allocation or shipment to report here."

DISTINGUISH EXPECTED AND CONFIRMED

"Tuesday remains estimated, not confirmed."

READ BACK THE CHAIN

"Back order, estimated Tuesday arrival, shipment and completion unconfirmed."

LIMIT THE PROMISE

"That is a communication commitment, not a guaranteed supply result."

RETAIN THE JOB REFERENCE

"Please keep job 315 attached to this parts update."

AVOID A GUARANTEED TURNAROUND

"The completion time is still unconfirmed."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT CONTACT

"You will hear from me Monday afternoon about the supply position."

Still needs confirmation

Keeps a remaining dependency visible.

Will update

Commits to communication rather than the hoped-for outcome.

Estimated, not confirmed

Preserves the level of certainty attached to the date.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement preserves the supplier information?

- A** Arrival is estimated for Tuesday, with shipment unconfirmed
- B** The part will definitely arrive Tuesday
- C** The part has already been dispatched
- D** Tuesday collection is booked

2. Why can Nia not promise Tuesday pickup?

- A** Monday afternoon is a repair deadline
- B** Every back order always takes a month
- C** Supply, technician scheduling, and completion are not confirmed
- D** The customer has not asked for pickup

3. What should Nia promise in this case?

- A** A supply-status update Monday afternoon
- B** Guaranteed installation Tuesday morning
- C** Confirmed shipment Monday morning
- D** A fixed completed-repair outcome

4. What does Ben's request establish?

- A** A guaranteed workshop slot
- B** Confirmation that the part is allocated
- C** A completed repair
- D** His preferred collection date, not an accepted promise

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Tuesday arrival is not Tuesday collection

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

back order / estimated arrival / progress checkpoint / pickup request / shipment confirmation / collection commitment / completion confirmation / supply-status update / order status / Workshop scheduling

- 01 **Ben:** I was told Tuesday for the part on job 315. Can I arrange to collect the vehicle that afternoon?
- 02 **Nia:** The part is on ¹ _____. The supplier has estimated Tuesday arrival, but shipment is not confirmed, so I cannot describe Tuesday collection as an agreed plan.
- 03 **Ben:** So Tuesday is the supplier's estimate, and you don't have a shipment confirmation yet?
- 04 **Nia:** We are still waiting for ² _____. I should keep the supplier estimate separate from evidence of dispatch rather than let the date sound more definite than it is.
- 05 **Ben:** Even if it arrives then, does that automatically put my vehicle into the workshop on Tuesday?
- 06 **Nia:** No. ³ _____ is not confirmed either. Part arrival, the work slot, and completion are distinct stages; the supply estimate does not establish all of them.
- 07 **Ben:** Tuesday pickup is what I'd like, but I understand you haven't accepted it as a booking.
- 08 **Nia:** I understand your ⁴ _____ for Tuesday. I will keep it in the notes as your preference, not as a confirmed handover date.
- 09 **Ben:** When will you check again and contact me? I'd rather have a clear update than keep calling.
- 10 **Nia:** I will provide a ⁵ _____ on Monday afternoon. That is my commitment to contact you, even though I cannot promise what the supplier's answer will be.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Ben:** Monday afternoon for the supply update. That doesn't mean the part will have shipped by then.
- 12 **Nia:** Exactly. It is a ⁶ _____, not a guaranteed dispatch or arrival. The update should distinguish what is confirmed from what remains estimated at that time.
- 13 **Ben:** Please don't change the collection request to confirmed in the notes. I need a real finish time before arranging transport.
- 14 **Nia:** A ⁷ _____ needs the relevant completion and handover confirmation. We do not yet have that, and I would not want your travel plans built on an unsupported promise.
- 15 **Ben:** Can you keep job 315 on the parts query, so the next advisor sees the same order?
- 16 **Nia:** Certainly. Job 315 will stay attached to the ⁸ _____ information. The note will identify the back order, the supplier's Tuesday estimate, and the missing shipment confirmation.
- 17 **Ben:** Read back the supplier estimate for me once. I'd been treating Tuesday as a promise.
- 18 **Nia:** The ⁹ _____ is Tuesday; shipment is unconfirmed. Technician scheduling and completion are also unconfirmed. I will update you about supply on Monday afternoon.
- 19 **Ben:** All right. I'll expect your Monday-afternoon update, with collection still unconfirmed.
- 20 **Nia:** Correct. We will keep ¹⁰ _____ separate from the parts forecast. You have a definite next update, but no invented guarantee about delivery, installation, or pickup.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. back order | 2. shipment confirmation | 3. Workshop scheduling | 4. pickup request | 5. supply-status update | 6. progress checkpoint | 7. collection commitment | 8. order status | 9. estimated arrival | 10. completion confirmation

Separate the supply forecast from collection

F Say it

Complete the delay update using the actual supplier estimate and Nia's communication commitment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Tuesday / order / confirmed / afternoon

Clerk: "The part is on back ¹ _____."

Customer: "The supplier estimates arrival on ² _____."

Clerk: "Shipment has not been ³ _____."

Customer: "The supply update is promised Monday ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. order | 2. Tuesday | 3. confirmed | 4. afternoon

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the parts-delay dialogue using the word bank.
2. Read the exchanges about Tuesday and Monday afternoon aloud. Keep estimated arrival, supply update, and collection separate.
3. Complete the transfer, then use the key to correct any phrase that turns an estimate into a confirmed commitment.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A code is a clue, not a replacement order

A Read the situation

Translate a diagnostic note into accurate customer language while separating recorded information, confirmed cause, and authorized work.

06

Technician Jules has recorded a diagnostic trouble code, abbreviated DTC, on job 416. The note gives no confirmed cause or component fault. Customer Tomas assumes the code proves that a sensor needs replacement. Advisor Ava must explain the limited finding and request a clearer technician explanation. No replacement is approved. Ava has no additional test results and must not invent them or tell Tomas how to diagnose the vehicle.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Customer | Ava: Service advisor

EXPLAIN THE TECHNICAL NOUN AND ITS EVIDENTIAL LIMIT

Using the full term once helps a customer follow the conversation. The more important distinction is what the information establishes. Explain what is recorded, what has not been confirmed, and whose clarification is needed before discussing a replacement decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the note record?

- A A completed replacement
- C A diagnostic trouble code

- B A guarantee of vehicle readiness
- D A confirmed sensor failure

2. What has Tomas assumed?

- A The advisor has no job number
- C No code was recorded

- B The invoice has already been paid
- D The sensor must need replacement

3. What should Ava request next?

- A Automatic sensor replacement
- C A promise that the code is harmless

- B An invented test result
- D A clearer technician explanation

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

diagnostic trouble code

Coded diagnostic information; abbreviated DTC.

IN USE record a diagnostic trouble code

on-board diagnostics

Vehicle monitoring and reporting systems; abbreviated OBD.

IN USE refer to on-board diagnostics

scan tool

Device for accessing supported diagnostic information.

IN USE identify the scan-tool record

control module

Electronic unit managing specified vehicle functions.

IN USE identify the control module

sensor

Component detecting a condition and supplying a signal.

IN USE distinguish a sensor from its circuit

actuator

Component carrying out a commanded physical action.

IN USE identify the actuator

circuit

Connected electrical path for a function.

IN USE identify the relevant circuit

malfunction indicator lamp

Dashboard warning indicator; abbreviated MIL.

IN USE report an illuminated lamp

stored code

Code retained in diagnostic memory.

IN USE identify a stored code

pending code

Provisional code status, not a repair diagnosis.

IN USE distinguish a pending code

freeze-frame data

Snapshot of operating information for a recorded event.

IN USE interpret freeze-frame data

live data

Supported information displayed as conditions are read.

IN USE distinguish live data

06

Precision check

DTC expands to diagnostic trouble code. It does not expand to a repair instruction. Job 416 contains a code, but the note does not identify a confirmed cause or component fault. Do not invent a code number or sensor type.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assessment note

Technician record of the examination and available findings.

IN USE read the assessment note

confirmed cause

Explanation supported by the completed relevant assessment.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed cause

component fault

Established problem attributed to a particular part.

IN USE avoid inventing a component fault

diagnostic evidence

Information relevant to investigating a reported problem.

IN USE explain the diagnostic evidence

fault tracing

Investigation intended to locate the source of a problem.

IN USE distinguish fault tracing from code reading

replacement decision

Conclusion that a particular item should be replaced.

IN USE support a replacement decision

technician clarification

Further explanation supplied by the relevant technician.

IN USE request technician clarification

finding

Information established or recorded during an assessment.

IN USE relay the limited finding

interpretation

Explanation of what information means in context.

IN USE separate a record from its interpretation

repair authorization

Customer permission for a specified repair under the stated terms.

IN USE obtain repair authorization

unsupported inference

Conclusion not established by the available information.

IN USE correct an unsupported inference

plain-language explanation

Account using accessible words without changing the technical meaning.

IN USE provide a plain-language explanation

Precision check

Ava can relay the recorded finding and request clarification. The vocabulary introduces common diagnostic terms without claiming they all appear in this job. No replacement has been approved, and the conversation does not establish vehicle safety or readiness.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

EXPAND THE ABBREVIATION

"DTC stands for diagnostic trouble code."

STATE THE FINDING

"The note records a code."

SEPARATE THE COMPONENT

"It does not establish that this sensor has failed."

AVOID INVENTED DETAIL

"I do not have a specific test result to quote."

IDENTIFY THE SOURCE

"I am reading the technician note for job 416."

EXPLAIN THE LIMIT

"It does not confirm the cause."

CORRECT THE INFERENCE

"A code is not automatically a replacement instruction."

PRESERVE THE UNCERTAINTY

"The cause remains unconfirmed in this note."

06

Stands for

Introduces the full form of an abbreviation.

Does not establish

Limits a conclusion without denying that information was recorded.

Automatically

Identifies the mistaken leap from code to replacement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

IDENTIFY THE MISSING EXPLANATION

"We need the technician to explain what the finding supports."

USE ACCESSIBLE LANGUAGE

"The system recorded information that needs interpretation."

AVOID A SAFETY CONCLUSION

"This note does not give me a vehicle-readiness confirmation."

STATE THE NEXT ACTION

"I will request a clearer explanation from Jules."

REQUEST CLARIFICATION

"Could you clarify whether a component fault has been established?"

DISTINGUISH AUTHORIZATION

"No replacement has been approved."

CHECK THE UNDERSTANDING

"Are we agreed that the code alone does not settle the repair?"

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I will keep the recorded code separate from any later repair proposal."

06

In this note

Defines the information available to the speaker.

Has been approved

Refers to authorization, not simply a proposed action.

What the finding supports

Requests an evidence-based explanation rather than a more confident guess.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** No further explanation is needed
- B** A code is recorded, but the cause is not confirmed
- C** The sensor has definitely failed
- D** The code proves the vehicle is ready

2. Which abbreviation is correctly expanded?

- A** DTC: direct technician clearance
- B** DTC: delivery timing confirmation
- C** DTC: defective transmission component
- D** DTC: diagnostic trouble code

3. Which sentence invents evidence?

- A** No replacement is approved
- B** We need Jules to clarify the finding
- C** Jules tested the sensor and proved it faulty
- D** The note contains a code

4. Which handoff respects the approval limit?

- A** Promise a free replacement today
- B** Request clarification before any separate repair proposal
- C** Replace the sensor because Tomas mentioned it
- D** Treat a recorded code as permission

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

A code is a clue, not a replacement order

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assessment note / plain-language explanation / diagnostic trouble code / replacement decision / technician clarification / repair authorization / finding / component fault / interpretation / unsupported inference

- 01 **Tomas:** The message about 416 says there's a code. Does that mean you've found a bad sensor and ordered a replacement?
- 02 **Ava:** Not from this note. It records a ¹ _____, or DTC, but doesn't confirm the cause.
- 03 **Tomas:** I thought a code was basically the name of the part you needed. Otherwise, what is it telling us?
- 04 **Ava:** It can guide the investigation; it isn't automatically a ² _____. A recorded code isn't an instruction to order a sensor.
- 05 **Tomas:** Did Jules test that sensor, then? Perhaps there's another result missing from the message I received.
- 06 **Ava:** I can't see one here. The ³ _____ records the code, with no supplied sensor-test result or confirmed component fault.
- 07 **Tomas:** That's the part I'm struggling with. I've got technical information, but I still don't know what you've actually established.
- 08 **Ava:** The recorded ⁴ _____ is limited to the code. Its cause and whether a part needs replacing aren't established in this note.
- 09 **Tomas:** So a reference to a system or circuit wouldn't, by itself, prove the sensor is defective?
- 10 **Ava:** Correct. We haven't established a ⁵ _____. I'm explaining the note's limit, not proposing a different diagnosis.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Tomas:** Could you ask Jules to explain what the evidence does show? I need something more useful than just reading the code back.
- 12 **Ava:** I'll request ⁶ _____ on what the assessment establishes and what remains unresolved before a repair proposal can be explained.
- 13 **Tomas:** Also, my question about a new sensor wasn't a request to buy one. Please don't treat it as an order.
- 14 **Ava:** Understood. No ⁷ _____ has been given. I'll record your question as a request for explanation, not permission to order or fit a part.
- 15 **Tomas:** Can I collect the vehicle while that explanation is being sorted out? Or has nobody confirmed that either?
- 16 **Ava:** I have no readiness confirmation here. A ⁸ _____ of a code mustn't become a claim that the vehicle is ready or safe.
- 17 **Tomas:** Tell Jules why I'm confused, please. I read code as sensor failure, and that's where the conversation went off track.
- 18 **Ava:** I'll include that. It's an ⁹ _____ from the available note, and the clarification should address that specific misunderstanding.
- 19 **Tomas:** All right: code recorded, cause unconfirmed, no replacement approved. I need Jules's explanation, not a parts order.
- 20 **Ava:** I'll request that ¹⁰ _____ against job 416. Any later repair proposal remains separate from this clarification and will need its own approval.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. diagnostic trouble code | 2. replacement decision | 3. assessment note | 4. finding | 5. component fault | 6. technician clarification | 7. repair authorization | 8. plain-language explanation | 9. unsupported inference | 10. interpretation

Relay the finding without upgrading it

F Say it

Complete the advisor readback. Use the recorded evidence and approval status only.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

code / clarification / confirmed / approved

Advisor: "DTC means diagnostic trouble ¹ _____."

Customer: "The cause has not been ² _____."

Advisor: "I will request technician ³ _____."

Customer: "No replacement has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. code | 2. confirmed | 3. clarification | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the dialogue about the recorded code.
2. Read Tomas's misunderstanding and Ava's correction aloud. Keep code, confirmed cause, repair approval, and readiness distinct.
3. Complete the transfer and check each explanation. Reread the corrected explanation without naming an unsupported failed part.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The bill is ready; the vehicle status is not

A Read the situation

Explain a two-line invoice accurately and separate a financial document from verified collection readiness.

The fictional invoice for job 527 totals \$180: \$70 for parts and \$110 for labor. Customer Imani thinks the labor line includes another \$70 parts charge. Advisor Leo must explain that the two listed charges add to \$180, not \$250. The service desk has not yet confirmed vehicle readiness. Issuing an invoice does not itself confirm collection. No additional fees, taxes, payment status, or release arrangements are supplied.

PEOPLE / Imani: Customer | Leo: Service advisor

07

EXPLAIN THE ARITHMETIC BEFORE DEFENDING THE BILL

A customer can question a charge without accusing anyone of dishonesty. Identify the two lines and show how they form the stated total. Then address collection separately, so a successful billing explanation does not become an accidental readiness promise.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the stated invoice total?

A \$180

B \$250

C \$110

D \$70

2. What has Imani misunderstood?

A She has been given a new tax rate

B She thinks another \$70 parts charge is included in labor

C She thinks all parts are free

D She has received a confirmed collection time

3. What remains unconfirmed?

A Vehicle readiness

B The two listed amounts

C The invoice total

D The job number

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

invoice

Document listing charges for supplied work or items.

IN USE explain the invoice

line item

Separately listed entry on a bill or estimate.

IN USE identify each line item

parts charge

Amount billed for the listed vehicle components or materials.

IN USE distinguish the parts charge

labor charge

Amount billed for the stated work rather than the parts.

IN USE explain the labor charge

invoice total

Combined amount shown as payable on the invoice.

IN USE confirm the invoice total

duplicate charge

Amount billed again for the same chargeable item.

IN USE investigate a suspected duplicate charge

itemized bill

Bill that separates charges into identifiable entries.

IN USE read the itemized bill

billing query

Customer request for clarification about a charge.

IN USE resolve a billing query

arithmetic

Calculation of the amounts involved.

IN USE check the arithmetic

subtotal

Amount before any separately applicable later additions or deductions.

IN USE distinguish a subtotal from the stated total

tax line

Separate entry identifying an applicable tax charge.

IN USE avoid inventing a tax line

discount

Reduction from an otherwise stated price.

IN USE identify an authorized discount

Precision check

The arithmetic is $\$70 + \$110 = \$180$. The labor line is not $\$110$ plus an additional $\$70$ parts charge. The supplied invoice has no third charge. Explain the stated figures without introducing a tax rate, discount, or payment.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

credit adjustment

Recorded reduction or correction applied to an account.

IN USE distinguish a credit adjustment

balance due

Amount still payable after relevant recorded payments or credits.

IN USE verify the balance due

payment status

Record of whether and how an amount has been paid.

IN USE check payment status

receipt

Record acknowledging a payment or transaction.

IN USE distinguish a receipt from an unpaid invoice

invoice date

Date assigned to the issued billing document.

IN USE verify the invoice date

job reference

Identifier linking the bill and service record.

IN USE match the job reference

collection readiness

Confirmed status for the relevant vehicle handover arrangements.

IN USE verify collection readiness

service desk

Team or location coordinating service information and handover.

IN USE check with the service desk

handover confirmation

Verified information that the agreed transfer can proceed.

IN USE obtain handover confirmation

release arrangements

Agreed details governing the transfer of the vehicle.

IN USE confirm release arrangements

billing record

Account of charges and related financial entries.

IN USE correct the billing record

readiness check

Request to verify the vehicle's current handover status.

IN USE request a readiness check

Precision check

An invoice and a readiness confirmation serve different purposes. The invoice explains charges; the service desk must confirm collection status. Do not infer that the customer has paid, the vehicle is ready, or a particular release requirement has been met.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INVITE THE QUERY

"Which line would you like me to explain?"

SEPARATE THE ENTRIES

"There are two listed charges."

NAME THE SECOND AMOUNT

"The labor charge is \$110."

CORRECT THE DUPLICATE ASSUMPTION

"There is no additional \$70 parts charge in that labor line."

IDENTIFY THE REFERENCE

"We are looking at job 527."

NAME THE FIRST AMOUNT

"The parts charge is \$70."

STATE THE CALCULATION

"Seventy plus one hundred ten equals one hundred eighty."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONFUSION

"I can see why the layout prompted that question."

07

Plus versus included in

Distinguishes adding two lines from imagining another charge inside one line.

There are two

Limits the explanation to the supplied invoice entries.

Prompted that question

Acknowledges confusion without accepting an incorrect calculation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP TO THE SUPPLIED BILL

"I will not add a charge that is not listed."

SEPARATE DOCUMENTS

"A bill and a receipt are not the same record."

STATE THE MISSING STATUS

"The service desk has not confirmed readiness yet."

REQUEST THE HANDOFF CHECK

"Please confirm the collection position for job 527."

AVOID ASSUMING PAYMENT

"The invoice alone does not establish payment status."

SWITCH TO COLLECTION

"Let us check readiness separately from the invoice."

AVOID A FALSE INVITATION

"I cannot ask you to collect on the basis of this document alone."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The invoice total is clear; collection remains unconfirmed."

Alone

Identifies the limit of what a single document establishes.

Yet

States the current absence of confirmation without promising when it will arrive.

Separately from

Keeps financial clarification and collection status distinct.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation resolves the billing query?

- A** \$70 parts plus \$110 labor gives the \$180 total
- B** \$70 parts must be added twice
- C** Labor is another name for parts
- D** The total is \$250 before an invented discount

2. Which statement wrongly infers readiness?

- A** The invoice exists, so come and collect now
- B** The desk has not confirmed readiness
- C** We should check collection separately
- D** The bill identifies the charges

3. What can Leo say about payment?

- A** The supplied facts do not establish payment status
- B** The full amount has definitely been paid
- C** A receipt proves an unpaid balance
- D** The customer owes an invented late fee

4. Which request should Leo send?

- A** Issue a driving-safety guarantee
- B** Tell the customer the car is ready without checking
- C** Confirm collection status for job 527
- D** Add another \$70 to labor

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The bill is ready; the vehicle status is not

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

invoice total / handover confirmation / collection readiness / itemized bill / parts charge / readiness check / payment status / billing query / billing record / job reference

07

- 01 **Imani:** The invoice for 527 says seventy for parts and a hundred ten for labor. I added seventy to the total and got two hundred fifty.
- 02 **Leo:** No. There are two separate entries on this ¹ _____. The parts charge is seventy dollars and the labor charge is one hundred ten dollars.
- 03 **Imani:** Then the parts are already in the hundred eighty. I shouldn't add them again.
- 04 **Leo:** Correct. The ² _____ is one hundred eighty dollars: seventy plus one hundred ten. There is no extra seventy-dollar parts charge inside the labor line.
- 05 **Imani:** Could you point out the total separately from the two charges? That's where I went wrong.
- 06 **Leo:** I understand the ³ _____. The layout led you to ask whether parts were being charged twice. Here, the two lines represent parts and labor separately.
- 07 **Imani:** I'm asking about the calculation, not a discount. The same parts charge should appear only once in the sum.
- 08 **Leo:** Certainly. The ⁴ _____ is seventy dollars. Labor is one hundred ten dollars. Those two figures produce the stated total of one hundred eighty dollars.
- 09 **Imani:** Does having the invoice mean I can come and collect the vehicle now?
- 10 **Leo:** Please let me check ⁵ _____ separately. The service desk has not confirmed it yet, so I should not invite you to collect on the strength of the invoice.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Imani:** Please leave the itemized charges as they are. It was my addition that needed correcting.
- 12 **Leo:** Yes. The ⁶ _____ tells us about the charges. It does not, by itself, give the missing handover confirmation or settle when you should travel here.
- 13 **Imani:** Also, I haven't told you I've paid. An invoice total isn't a payment confirmation.
- 14 **Leo:** We have not established ⁷ _____ in this conversation. An invoice is not automatically a receipt, and I will not say a payment has been made without the relevant record.
- 15 **Imani:** Could you check readiness separately before I make the trip?
- 16 **Leo:** Exactly. We have clarified the arithmetic. The next ⁸ _____ should go to the service desk for job 527, without treating the bill as proof of readiness.
- 17 **Imani:** Use job 527 for that check, please. I want the readiness message linked to the same vehicle record.
- 18 **Leo:** I will match the ⁹ _____ before requesting confirmation. The figures we discussed remain seventy for parts and one hundred ten for labor, totaling one hundred eighty.
- 19 **Imani:** So the bill is seventy plus a hundred ten, total a hundred eighty; collection still needs confirmation.
- 20 **Leo:** Understood. We still need ¹⁰ _____. I will keep the billing explanation and the collection inquiry clear, so resolving one does not accidentally promise the other.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. itemized bill | 2. invoice total | 3. billing query | 4. parts charge | 5. collection readiness | 6. billing record | 7. payment status | 8. readiness check | 9. job reference | 10. handover confirmation

Explain the bill and preserve the handoff limit

F Say it

Complete the customer-service exchange using the two charges and the unresolved collection status.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seventy / ten / unconfirmed / eighty

Advisor: "The parts charge is ¹ _____ dollars."

Customer: "The labor charge is one hundred ² _____ dollars."

Advisor: "The two charges total one hundred ³ _____ dollars."

Customer: "Collection readiness is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. seventy | 2. ten | 3. eighty | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the invoice dialogue.
2. Read the arithmetic aloud: seventy for parts plus one hundred ten for labor equals one hundred eighty. Then read the separate readiness exchange.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Correct any answer that counts the parts twice or treats an invoice as a collection confirmation.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Correct the dismissal before arranging the callback

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a repeat report, correct an unsupported dismissal, and arrange a specific review without promising a diagnosis or coverage.

Two days after service, customer Farah reports the same intermittent rattle. Advisor Daniel initially said, "That cannot be the same issue." The cause and warranty coverage are unknown. Service lead Nia can call at 15:00 to review the report and next arrangements. Daniel must withdraw the unsupported statement, record what Farah reports, and explain the purpose of the callback. The call is not a repair appointment or a promise of free work.

PEOPLE / Farah: Customer | Daniel: Service advisor

08

CORRECT YOUR OWN STATEMENT EXPLICITLY

A calm apology is stronger when it identifies what was wrong. Withdraw the unsupported dismissal without swinging to an equally unsupported promise. Preserve the customer report, distinguish it from a confirmed cause, and make the next contact useful and specific.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Farah report?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A confirmed new component fault | B A written warranty decision |
| C A continuous noise proven unrelated to service | D The same intermittent rattle two days after service |

2. What should Daniel correct?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The supplied callback time | B Farah's right to describe the sound |
| C An established technician diagnosis | D His claim that it cannot be the same issue |

3. What can Nia do at 15:00?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Receive the vehicle at an already booked repair slot | B Call to review the report and next arrangements |
| C Complete a guaranteed free repair | D Confirm coverage without review |

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

repeat concern

Problem reported again after an earlier visit or intervention.

IN USE acknowledge a repeat concern

return complaint

Customer report that brings an unresolved or recurring concern back to the business.

IN USE record the return complaint

service history

Record of previous vehicle visits and relevant work.

IN USE review the service history

repair record

Account of the specified work performed during a service visit.

IN USE consult the repair record

reported recurrence

Customer account that a symptom has happened again.

IN USE preserve the reported recurrence

intermittent symptom

Experienced condition that occurs at intervals.

IN USE describe an intermittent symptom

same symptom

Similar experienced behavior or sound, without proving the same cause.

IN USE distinguish the same symptom from the same cause

underlying cause

Explanation responsible for the reported condition.

IN USE avoid assuming the underlying cause

unsupported dismissal

Rejection of a report without adequate evidence.

IN USE withdraw an unsupported dismissal

acknowledgment

Clear recognition that the report has been heard and recorded.

IN USE give a specific acknowledgment

apology

Statement accepting responsibility for an inappropriate response.

IN USE make a direct apology

correction

Explicit replacement of an inaccurate statement.

IN USE put the correction on record

08

Precision check

Farah reports the same rattle, not a proven identical cause. Daniel should correct his statement that the issue cannot be the same. He should not replace that dismissal with a claim that the earlier repair definitely failed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service lead

Person responsible for coordinating the relevant service review.

IN USE refer the report to the service lead

callback

Return telephone contact arranged for a stated purpose.

IN USE confirm the callback

review appointment

Arranged discussion or assessment, defined by its actual scope.

IN USE clarify the review appointment

next arrangements

Further practical steps to be agreed after the review.

IN USE discuss next arrangements

warranty coverage

Protection that depends on the applicable terms and relevant facts.

IN USE check warranty coverage

service contract

Separate agreement describing specified services or protection.

IN USE distinguish a service contract from a warranty

coverage determination

Decision about whether stated protection applies.

IN USE avoid promising a coverage determination

goodwill offer

Discretionary concession made by a business.

IN USE avoid inventing a goodwill offer

no-charge work

Work supplied without a stated customer charge.

IN USE distinguish no-charge work from a review call

follow-up record

Account of contacts and steps after the original service.

IN USE update the follow-up record

complaint ownership

Responsibility for handling the stated concern or communication.

IN USE clarify complaint ownership

communication repair

Correction of a mishandled exchange through acknowledgment and accurate follow-up.

IN USE begin communication repair

Precision check

Nia can call at 15:00 to review the report and next arrangements. That is not an appointment for a completed repair. Warranty coverage and cause remain unknown, and Daniel has no authority in the supplied facts to promise no-charge work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE RETURN

"You are reporting the same intermittent rattle."

OWN THE EARLIER WORDING

"I said it could not be the same issue."

APOLOGIZE DIRECTLY

"I am sorry I dismissed your report."

KEEP SYMPTOMS AND CAUSES SEPARATE

"A similar sound does not by itself prove an identical cause."

PRESERVE THE TIMING

"You noticed it again two days after service."

WITHDRAW THE CLAIM

"I should not have made that statement."

STATE THE UNCERTAINTY

"We have not established the cause."

AVOID REVERSING INTO CERTAINTY

"I cannot say the previous work definitely failed either."

08

I should not have

Accepts responsibility for a specific past statement.

Reporting the same

Attributes similarity to the customer's experience.

By itself

Limits what one observation can prove.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE HISTORY

"I will keep this report with the earlier service record."

SPECIFY THE TIME

"Nia can call at 15:00."

LIMIT THE COMMITMENT

"This is not a confirmed repair appointment."

AVOID AN UNAUTHORIZED CONCESSION

"I cannot promise no-charge work from the information available."

NAME THE CONTACT

"Nia is the service lead handling the review call."

EXPLAIN THE PURPOSE

"The call is to review your report and next arrangements."

KEEP COVERAGE OPEN

"Warranty coverage has not been determined."

CLOSE WITH A READBACK

"Your report is recorded, my earlier dismissal is corrected, and the review call is at 15:00."

08

Either

Prevents the correction from becoming an opposite unsupported claim.

Can call at

Specifies an available contact commitment rather than repair completion.

Has not been determined

Keeps coverage unresolved without denying that it might apply.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which apology is most appropriate?

- A** I am sorry I dismissed your report; the cause has not been established
- B** I am sorry you failed to understand our diagnosis
- C** The sound is impossible, but I will call you
- D** I apologize, so the repair will definitely be free

2. Which note preserves the evidence?

- A** Warranty claim denied after full review
- B** Customer reports same intermittent rattle two days after service
- C** Technician proved the original repair failed
- D** New cause confirmed unrelated to earlier work

3. What does 15:00 refer to?

- A** The time warranty coverage automatically begins
- B** Nia's review call
- C** Completion of a free repair
- D** A confirmed collection slot

4. Which response answers the coverage question accurately?

- A** A recurrence within two days automatically guarantees free repair
- B** The apology confirms a covered failure
- C** An unknown cause means coverage has been denied
- D** Coverage needs review; the callback does not decide it

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

Correct the dismissal before arranging the callback

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

service history / follow-up record / Warranty coverage / repeat concern / service lead / unsupported dismissal / communication repair / callback / reported recurrence / underlying cause

08

- 01 **Farah:** The same rattle is back two days after the service. When you said that couldn't be the same issue, it sounded like you weren't listening.
- 02 **Daniel:** I'm sorry. That was an ¹ _____. I had no basis to say it couldn't be the same issue.
- 03 **Farah:** I can't tell you which part is involved. I just recognize the same intermittent sound, and I want that taken seriously.
- 04 **Daniel:** I'll record a ² _____ of the same intermittent rattle, two days after service. The cause isn't established yet.
- 05 **Farah:** Will Nia see the earlier visit? I don't want to start again as though nobody has worked on the vehicle.
- 06 **Daniel:** Yes. I'll connect this report to the ³ _____ so she can review it alongside the previous record.
- 07 **Farah:** Does that mean you're accepting that the repair failed? I need to understand what your apology actually covers.
- 08 **Daniel:** I'm correcting my response. The ⁴ _____ is still unknown, so I can't say the earlier work failed or that this concern is unrelated.
- 09 **Farah:** Fair enough. Who is actually going to follow this up, and when will I hear from them?
- 10 **Daniel:** Nia, our ⁵ _____, can call at 15:00 to review your report and discuss the next arrangements.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Farah:** Three this afternoon, by phone? I don't need to bring the car in at three?
- 12 **Daniel:** Right, it's a ⁶ _____ at three. It isn't a repair booking, a collection time, or a promise of completion.
- 13 **Farah:** I'll be available. But I do need to ask about cost: the service was only two days ago.
- 14 **Daniel:** I understand. ⁷ _____ hasn't been determined. I can't promise free work or rule coverage out from what we have.
- 15 **Farah:** Please pass that question on too. I don't want the call to end with me explaining the cost concern all over again.
- 16 **Daniel:** I'll put it in the ⁸ _____ with your report and my correction. There won't be a coverage decision recorded before one is made.
- 17 **Farah:** Could you read back the arrangement, so I know exactly what Nia will receive?
- 18 **Daniel:** Your ⁹ _____ is linked to the earlier visit: same intermittent rattle, two days later. My dismissal is withdrawn; Nia can call at 15:00 to review it.
- 19 **Farah:** Yes. I understand the call doesn't settle the cause or the cost, but at least the earlier report won't be lost.
- 20 **Daniel:** That's the start of the ¹⁰ _____. I'll pass on the complete history and coverage question, with the agreed call time and no invented outcome.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. unsupported dismissal | 2. reported recurrence | 3. service history | 4. underlying cause | 5. service lead | 6. callback | 7. Warranty coverage | 8. follow-up record | 9. repeat concern | 10. communication repair

Recover the conversation accurately

F Say it

Complete the follow-up readback. Keep the apology, report, contact time, and unresolved coverage distinct.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

intermittent / dismissed / 15:00 / unknown

08

Advisor: "I should not have ¹ _____ your report."

Customer: "The rattle is still ² _____."

Advisor: "Nia can call at ³ _____."

Customer: "Warranty coverage remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. dismissed | 2. intermittent | 3. 15:00 | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the complaint-recovery dialogue.
2. Read the apology and next-contact exchanges aloud. Name Nia, 15:00, and the purpose of the call; retain the unresolved cause and coverage.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Reread the full follow-up with the report attributed to the customer.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Read the whole tire description

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain a tire quotation without confusing dimensions, rating codes, and vehicle suitability.

Fictional quotation lists 205/55 R16 91V. Read 205 as nominal section width in millimeters, 55 as sidewall-height percentage of that width, R as radial construction, and 16 as rim diameter in inches. The service description is 91V: load index plus speed rating. Vehicle fitment and pressure requirements have not been checked. This is a document discussion, not fitting or inflation guidance.

PEOPLE / Alina: Customer | Marco: Parts advisor

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

load index / aspect ratio / speed rating / nominal section width / radial construction / rim diameter

- 01 **Alina:** Marco, the quote says two-oh-five, fifty-five, R sixteen, ninety-one V. I understand it's a tire size, but which numbers should I keep when comparing another quote?
- 02 **Marco:** Keep the whole description. Two hundred five is the ¹ _____ in millimeters. It isn't the depth of the tread or the diameter of the wheel.
- 03 **Alina:** Then fifty-five must be the sidewall height in millimeters? That's what I wrote beside it, but perhaps I've mixed a ratio with a dimension.
- 04 **Marco:** It's the ² _____: fifty-five percent of the width. On that nominal basis, zero point five five times two hundred five is one hundred twelve point seven five millimeters.
- 05 **Alina:** That arithmetic explains the proportion, but it doesn't mean somebody measured this particular tire at exactly that height. What does the R add?
- 06 **Marco:** It denotes ³ _____, not radius or rear position. We shouldn't drop the letter and treat the remaining numbers as a complete description.
- 07 **Alina:** And sixteen is in inches, even though the width was in millimeters. Is sixteen the diameter across the whole outside of the tire?
- 08 **Marco:** No, it's the ⁴ _____. That's a different dimension from the tire's overall outside diameter. The units and the thing being measured both matter.
- 09 **Alina:** Now the ninety-one. Does that mean each tire is rated to carry ninety-one kilograms, or is it a code that needs a table?
- 10 **Marco:** It's a ⁵ _____, not a weight stated directly in kilograms. Its rating must be checked against the applicable information and the vehicle's requirements.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Alina:** So I shouldn't compare only the first three numbers and ignore ninety-one V. The final letter is another rating, not just a product series?
- 12 **Marco:** Yes, V is the ⁶ _____ symbol. It's not a recommendation to drive at that speed or proof that this tire is suitable for your vehicle.
- 13 **Alina:** The other quote lists a different service description with the same size. Can I call them identical just because two-oh-five, fifty-five, and sixteen match?
- 14 **Marco:** Not identical on that evidence. We need the complete specification and the vehicle requirements before confirming an appropriate replacement. A matching size alone doesn't settle every requirement.
- 15 **Alina:** I also see a maximum-pressure marking in a sidewall photograph. Is that the number the vehicle normally wants, regardless of its own label?
- 16 **Marco:** No. A tire's maximum marking isn't the vehicle's recommended operating pressure. The vehicle's actual placard and manufacturer information are separate references, not optional details.
- 17 **Alina:** Please don't turn this question into an order yet. I want the comparison clarified before anyone assumes the quoted tire has been approved for fitting.
- 18 **Marco:** Understood. We'll keep the quotation and fitment check distinct. This conversation explains the code; it doesn't confirm installation suitability, tire condition, or vehicle readiness.
- 19 **Alina:** I'll retain the full 205/55 R16 91V entry, with millimeter width, percentage aspect ratio, radial construction, inch rim size, and the two rating codes.
- 20 **Marco:** That's a useful readback. Send the competing full description with the vehicle reference, so the review compares actual specifications rather than a shortened version that loses important information.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. nominal section width | 2. aspect ratio | 3. radial construction | 4. rim diameter | 5. load index | 6. speed rating

Decode a second quotation

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional quote reads 225/45 R17 94W. Interpret the dimensional fields using the same definitions. No vehicle-fitment review has been completed; the different code is not a recommendation to substitute tires.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

45 / unapproved / 17 / 225

09

Customer: The nominal section width is ¹ _____ millimeters.

Advisor: The aspect ratio is ² _____ percent.

Customer: The rim diameter is ³ _____ inches.

Advisor: Fitment remains ⁴ _____ .

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 225 | 2. 45 | 3. 17 | 4. unapproved

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Charge added is not wall energy

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain an electric-vehicle charging estimate with separate battery energy, input limits, losses, and cost.

Fictional electric vehicle: usable battery 60 kWh, charge from 20 to 80 percent. For this simplified estimate, percentages map linearly to usable energy. Compatible AC point offers 7.4 kW; vehicle accepts at most 7.2 kW AC. Assume constant 7.2 kW wall input and 90 percent wall-to-stored-energy efficiency, including all losses. Energy-only tariff \$0.25/kWh; no other charges. Actual charging time is not guaranteed.

PEOPLE / Ben: Vehicle owner | Nadia: Service advisor

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

usable capacity / state of charge / charging efficiency / energy charge / AC input limit / wall energy

- 01 **Ben:** The battery is sixty kilowatt-hours and I'm charging from twenty to eighty percent. I divided sixty by the point's seven point four kilowatts for the time.
- 02 **Nadia:** Start with the change in ¹ _____. You're adding sixty percentage points, not charging the whole usable battery from empty.
- 03 **Ben:** Sixty percent of sixty is thirty-six kilowatt-hours. That is the increase stored in the battery under this worksheet's simplified percentage assumption.
- 04 **Nadia:** Right. Use the supplied ² _____, not an unrelated gross-capacity figure from another model. The energy increase is thirty-six, not sixty or eighty kilowatt-hours.
- 05 **Ben:** The point can offer seven point four kilowatts, but the car accepts only seven point two on AC. Which one belongs in the time calculation?
- 06 **Nadia:** The vehicle's ³ _____ is the lower figure here. Under our assumptions, we use seven point two kilowatts, not the point's higher advertised capability.
- 07 **Ben:** If thirty-six is stored, is thirty-six also what the meter bills? The worksheet says ninety percent reaches stored battery energy after all losses.
- 08 **Nadia:** No. The ⁴ _____ is thirty-six divided by zero point nine: forty kilowatt-hours. The four-kilowatt-hour difference represents the losses already included in this model.
- 09 **Ben:** Then adding another ten percent to forty would count the same loss assumption twice. And thirty-six times one point one wouldn't quite give the right input either.
- 10 **Nadia:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ is stored energy divided by wall energy. Divide to find input; don't add a second allowance after the forty-kilowatt-hour result.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Ben:** Forty divided by seven point two is about five point five six hours. That's roughly five hours thirty-three minutes, not five hours fifty-six.
- 12 **Nadia:** Correct. The decimal fraction is part of an hour. The ⁶ _____ is forty times twenty-five cents, or ten dollars, under the supplied energy-only tariff.
- 13 **Ben:** Would an eleven-kilowatt AC point make this car charge proportionately faster? Its label would be higher, but the car's AC limit hasn't changed.
- 14 **Nadia:** Not in this case. The same vehicle input limit still applies. A higher point rating doesn't make the vehicle accept more than its supported AC rate.
- 15 **Ben:** And I shouldn't reuse this seven-point-two figure to describe DC fast charging as though it were the same charging path and limit.
- 16 **Nadia:** Right. DC charging has separate vehicle capability and charging behavior. This estimate is specifically for the compatible AC arrangement and assumptions supplied here.
- 17 **Ben:** Could I promise the car will be ready after exactly five hours thirty-three minutes? The real charge rate might not remain constant.
- 18 **Nadia:** Don't promise that. Battery condition, temperature, charging controls, and other constraints can change actual time. The constant-power worksheet is an estimate, not a completion booking.
- 19 **Ben:** I'll report thirty-six stored kilowatt-hours, forty from the wall, about five point five six hours at seven point two, and ten dollars energy cost.
- 20 **Nadia:** Keep the twenty-to-eighty range and ninety-percent assumption beside it. That explains the estimate without confusing power with energy, counting losses twice, or claiming a guaranteed charging result.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. state of charge | 2. usable capacity | 3. AC input limit | 4. wall energy | 5. charging efficiency | 6. energy charge

Use a different efficiency assumption

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional usable capacity 40 kWh; charge 25 to 75 percent on a linear usable-energy basis. Assume constant wall input 5 kW and 80 percent wall-to-stored efficiency including all losses. Energy-only rate \$0.24/kWh. No other fees or operating restrictions are modeled.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

25 / five / 20 / six

10

Owner: The increase in stored battery energy is ¹ _____ kWh.

Advisor: Required wall energy in the model is ² _____ kWh.

Owner: Modeled charging time is ³ _____ hours.

Advisor: The energy-only charge is ⁴ _____ dollars.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 20 | 2. 25 | 3. five | 4. six

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Minutes of angle are not decimals

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Read an alignment printout without confusing per-wheel values, total toe, units, and completion status.

Fictional BEFORE report: front left toe +0 degrees 06 minutes; right +0 degrees 12 minutes. Legend: positive means toe-in; total toe is their sum. Use 60 angular minutes = 1 degree. Supplied total-toe range is +0.10 to +0.20 decimal degrees, inclusive. Left camber is -0 degrees 30 minutes. AFTER values are blank. These invented limits are for record interpretation, not vehicle adjustment.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Service advisor | Arun: Alignment technician

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

camber / sign convention / total toe / decimal degrees / before readings / angular minutes

11

- 01 **Rosa:** Arun, the printout says left toe zero degrees six minutes and right zero degrees twelve minutes. I copied them as zero point zero six and zero point one two.
- 02 **Arun:** Those are ¹ _____, not decimal hundredths. Divide the minutes by sixty: six becomes zero point one zero degrees, and twelve becomes zero point two zero.
- 03 **Rosa:** Then the sum is zero point three zero degrees. My copied decimals would have produced zero point one eight, which would change the comparison.
- 04 **Arun:** Yes. Convert to ² _____ consistently before using the printed decimal range. Or add six and twelve minutes, then divide the eighteen by sixty.
- 05 **Rosa:** The limits are plus zero point one zero through plus zero point two zero. Should I compare each wheel separately against that range?
- 06 **Arun:** No, it is the supplied ³ _____ range. Each wheel and the axle total are different entries. Comparing the wrong entry could give a misleading pass statement.
- 07 **Rosa:** Our total is plus zero point three zero, which exceeds the upper end by zero point one zero. I shouldn't call it within range.
- 08 **Arun:** Correct. Preserve that result and the ⁴ _____. This report defines positive as toe-in. Don't drop the signs or substitute the convention from another document.
- 09 **Rosa:** The camber entry is minus zero degrees thirty minutes. That is minus zero point five zero degrees, not minus zero point three zero.
- 10 **Arun:** Exactly. Keep ⁵ _____ separate from toe. Its negative half-degree value doesn't get added into the front total-toe calculation.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Rosa:** The sheet title says alignment report, so I nearly told the customer the alignment was completed. But these figures sit in the BEFORE column.
- 12 **Arun:** The ⁶ _____ document the initial state. With the AFTER column blank, this extract doesn't establish an adjustment or a completed result.
- 13 **Rosa:** So the useful explanation is that the supplied initial total is outside this fictional range, with no final result recorded. We don't need to guess what was done.
- 14 **Arun:** Right. Ask for the actual completed assessment and work record. Don't fill the empty column by assuming the technician adjusted the value to the middle of the range.
- 15 **Rosa:** Another report uses millimeters for toe. Can I simply rename zero point three degrees as zero point three millimeters to match it?
- 16 **Arun:** No. An angular and a linear value aren't interchangeable. A distance-based toe figure depends on the defined reference diameter and reporting convention.
- 17 **Rosa:** Does explaining this printout establish that wheel balancing was done too? Customers sometimes use balance and alignment as though they mean the same service.
- 18 **Arun:** They are different matters. This alignment extract doesn't document balancing, and interpreting these angles doesn't diagnose every vibration, tire concern, or steering complaint.
- 19 **Rosa:** I'll retain the original minute values, show total plus zero point three zero degrees, note the supplied range, and leave the missing AFTER result explicit.
- 20 **Arun:** Good. That's a records explanation, not a setting instruction or a vehicle-safety release. The actual vehicle specification, assessment, work authorization, and final verification remain separate.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. angular minutes | 2. decimal degrees | 3. total toe | 4. sign convention | 5. camber | 6. before readings

Convert another initial report

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional BEFORE values: left toe +0 degrees 09 minutes and right +0 degrees 03 minutes. Positive means toe-in; total is the sum. Use 60 minutes per degree and two decimal places. The AFTER column is blank.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

0.15 / 0.05 / unrecorded / 0.20

Advisor: Left toe is +¹ _____ decimal degrees.

Technician: Right toe is +² _____ decimal degrees.

Advisor: Total toe is +³ _____ decimal degrees.

Technician: The final result is +⁴ _____ in this extract.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 0.15 | 2. 0.05 | 3. 0.20 | 4. unrecorded

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Capturing the customer's concern

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which vehicle is booked today?

D. The blue hatchback

The brief identifies the blue hatchback as the vehicle for this booking.

2. How does Mina describe the sound?

B. An occasional rattle from the rear

The report is intermittent and located toward the rear, without a confirmed cause.

3. What assessment has occurred?

C. None by a technician yet

No technician assessment has taken place at the point of this conversation.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which job-card wording preserves the account?

A. Customer reports occasional rear rattle after overnight parking in blue hatchback

The wording retains vehicle, attribution, sound, frequency, and reported conditions.

2. Which question is leading?

B. Which rear component has failed?

The question assumes a failed component before any assessment has occurred.

3. What should Ellis not add?

D. A precise cause or unreported driving condition

The account contains no verified cause or additional driving conditions.

4. Why should the vehicle be confirmed first?

B. Two cars are on the account and only one is booked

Confirming identity prevents the concern from being attached to the wrong household vehicle.

01 Conversation answers

Capturing the customer's concern

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. vehicle identification.** Turn 2. Vehicle identification prevents this concern from being recorded against the other household car.
- 2. booking reference.** Turn 4. Booking reference connects today's appointment to the selected vehicle rather than both cars.
- 3. intermittent.** Turn 6. Intermittent preserves Mina's description of an occasional sound rather than a constant one.
- 4. frequency.** Turn 8. Frequency is limited to occasional because Mina has not supplied a count or fixed pattern.
- 5. symptom description.** Turn 10. Symptom description captures the experienced sound and location without requiring a component diagnosis.
- 6. technician assessment.** Turn 12. Technician assessment has not occurred, so the concern must remain attributed to the customer.
- 7. reported conditions.** Turn 14. Reported conditions preserve the overnight-parking circumstance without treating it as proven causation.
- 8. job card.** Turn 16. Job card is the workshop record that should preserve the precise customer concern for assessment.
- 9. concern readback.** Turn 18. Concern readback checks the vehicle, intermittent sound, reported conditions, and unknown cause together.
- 10. customer concern.** Turn 20. Customer concern remains the owner's account, distinct from a later diagnosis or vehicle-safety conclusion.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. hatchback

Advisor: "The booked vehicle is the blue hatchback."

Hatchback identifies the selected household car for today's booking.

2. rattle

Customer: "I report an occasional rattle."

Rattle is the sound Mina described, not a diagnosis.

3. rear

Advisor: "You hear it from the rear."

Rear preserves the perceived location without naming a failed component.

4. overnight

Customer: "I have noticed it after overnight parking."

Overnight is the reported circumstance, not a proven cause of the noise.

02 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does 08:00 confirm?

C. Intake at drop-off

The booking confirms drop-off intake, not a workshop start or completion time.

2. What can Leila promise?

C. A status update by 10:00

The supplied commitment is an update deadline rather than a finished vehicle.

3. How does Omar prefer to receive the update?

B. By phone call

The brief explicitly identifies a phone call as the preferred method.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement best corrects Omar's expectation?

C. Eight is drop-off intake; start and finish are not confirmed

The correction explains the actual appointment while preserving uncertainty about workshop timing.

2. What does by 10:00 mean here?

B. The status call will be provided no later than 10:00

By establishes the latest promised communication time, not completion.

3. Which detail belongs in the contact notes?

B. Phone call preferred

The notes should preserve the explicitly stated phone preference.

4. Which promise exceeds Leila's stated authority?

C. The car will definitely be ready by 09:00

No completion guarantee is supplied, so a nine o'clock promise is unsupported.

02 Conversation answers

Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. drop-off. Turn 2. Drop-off identifies delivery of the vehicle, not an immediate start of technical work.

2. intake. Turn 4. Intake is the booked process of receiving the vehicle and recording the request.

3. completion time. Turn 6. Completion time has not been established by the intake booking or the customer's expectation.

4. status update. Turn 8. Status update is the communication Leila can promise, distinct from completed work.

5. phone preference. Turn 10. Phone preference preserves Omar's explicit choice of a telephone call rather than email.

6. update deadline. Turn 12. Update deadline is the latest promised time for the call, not an exact repair completion time.

7. waiting appointment. Turn 14. Waiting appointment would need its own stated arrangement and cannot be inferred from this intake booking.

8. collection time. Turn 16. Collection time needs actual readiness confirmation and is not established by the update deadline.

9. contact method. Turn 18. Contact method records how the promised update should reach Omar.

10. commitment readback. Turn 20. Commitment readback preserves the actual intake and call promises without inventing workshop timing.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 08:00

Advisor: "Drop-off intake is booked for 08:00."

Eight o'clock belongs to intake rather than a confirmed technician start.

2. phone

Customer: "I prefer a phone call."

Phone is the contact method explicitly requested by the customer.

3. 10:00

Advisor: "The status update will be provided by 10:00."

Ten is the latest promised update time, not the completion deadline.

4. unconfirmed

Customer: "The finish time remains unconfirmed."

No workshop duration or completion time is established by the booking.

03 Briefing and language checks

Explaining estimates and approval limits

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What does the \$95 cover in this booking?

D. Assessment only

The stated fictional terms cover assessment and explicitly exclude repair.

2. What does Hana intend by go ahead?

B. Permission for the assessment only

The customer intends the limited assessment described in the brief.

3. What must happen with a later repair proposal?

A. It needs separate approval

The supplied process requires a separate decision on any later repair proposal.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which readback is most accurate?

B. You authorize the \$95 assessment only; repair needs separate approval

The readback includes the stated service, amount, and authorization boundary.

2. What should Dev avoid promising?

D. A particular diagnostic result or unpriced repair

The brief supplies neither a guaranteed outcome nor a repair price.

3. What makes the original go ahead ambiguous?

A. It does not itself state the exact approved scope

A short approval phrase needs the agreed service and limit attached.

4. Which item belongs in the approval record?

B. Assessment only, \$95, with repair excluded

The record should preserve the permission actually given under the stated terms.

03 Conversation answers

Explaining estimates and approval limits

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. assessment scope.** Turn 2. Assessment scope defines the evaluation Hana is approving, separate from corrective work.
- 2. approval limit.** Turn 4. Approval limit preserves Hana's permission for assessment without extending it to unspecified repairs.
- 3. assessment fee.** Turn 6. Assessment fee is the stated \$95 charge for the defined evaluation service.
- 4. diagnostic outcome.** Turn 8. Diagnostic outcome is not guaranteed by the stated assessment fee or authorization.
- 5. repair proposal.** Turn 10. Repair proposal describes later corrective work and must be presented for a distinct customer decision.
- 6. component replacement.** Turn 12. Component replacement is corrective work outside the present assessment-only authorization.
- 7. separate approval.** Turn 14. Separate approval is required for any later repair outside the current assessment scope.
- 8. scope readback.** Turn 16. Scope readback repeats the service, price, and exclusion so Hana can confirm the actual agreement.
- 9. customer consent.** Turn 18. Customer consent applies to the specific assessment and stated terms, not to future unpriced work.
- 10. approval record.** Turn 20. Approval record documents the present limited permission so the workshop and later advisor receive the same instruction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 95

Advisor: "The authorized charge is 95 dollars."

Ninety-five dollars is the stated price of the assessment service.

2. assessment

Customer: "I approve the assessment only."

Assessment is the specific service Hana intends to authorize.

3. repair

Advisor: "No repair is included or approved."

Repair falls outside the current assessment-only agreement and stated charge.

4. separate

Customer: "Any later proposal needs separate approval."

Separate approval preserves a distinct decision for any later repair proposal.

04 Briefing and language checks

Handing the concern to the technician

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which job is being handed over?

A. Job card 208

The brief identifies 208 as the record for this internal handoff.

2. What is the authorization?

B. Assessment only

The customer has approved only assessment, not unspecified corrective work.

3. What contact arrangement is supplied?

D. Phone call after 14:00; unavailable 12:00-14:00

The brief states both the unavailable interval and the preferred later phone contact.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which handoff preserves all critical facts?

D. Job 208: intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking; assessment only; not reproduced; phone after 14:00

The full handoff retains identifier, concern, condition, permission, status, and contact arrangement.

2. What does not reproduced mean here?

C. Arun has not observed the reported concern during assessment

Non-reproduction describes the technician's observation limit, not the truth of the customer's history.

3. When should the preferred phone contact occur?

C. After 14:00, outside the stated unavailable interval

The supplied preference is a phone call after the unavailable interval ends.

4. What changes the approval limit during customer unavailability?

D. Nothing in these facts

The assessment-only authorization remains unchanged by the customer's contact restriction.

04 Conversation answers

Handing the concern to the technician

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. job identifier. Turn 2. Job identifier anchors the handoff to record 208 rather than another workshop job.

2. customer-reported. Turn 4. Customer-reported attributes the intermittent rattle to the owner's account rather than a verified technician finding.

3. Non-reproduction. Turn 6. Non-reproduction is a limited assessment result and does not prove the reported intermittent condition never occurs.

4. authorization boundary. Turn 8. Authorization boundary limits the approved work to assessment rather than corrective action.

5. unavailable interval. Turn 10. Unavailable interval is the stated 12:00-14:00 period that must remain in the contact notes.

6. contact window. Turn 12. Contact window begins after 14:00 but is not an exact appointment at 14:00.

7. preferred channel. Turn 14. Preferred channel is a telephone call, which must not be replaced with an assumed email update.

8. Repair authorization. Turn 16. Repair authorization is absent and is not created by difficulty contacting the customer.

9. confirmed cause. Turn 18. Confirmed cause has not been established, so it must not appear as an assumed diagnosis in the readback.

10. handoff readback. Turn 20. Handoff readback checks the complete transfer of technical and communication facts between colleagues.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 208

Advisor: "This is job card 208."

The handoff concerns record 208, not another service job.

2. assessment

Technician: "The approval covers assessment only."

Assessment is the stated authorization and does not include repair.

3. 14:00

Advisor: "The customer is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00."

Fourteen hundred is the end of the supplied unavailable interval.

4. phone

Technician: "They prefer a phone call afterward."

Phone preserves the requested contact method after the unavailable period.

05 Briefing and language checks

Explaining parts and completion delays

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the part's current status?

D. On back order with shipment unconfirmed

The part is back-ordered, and no shipment confirmation has been supplied.

2. What does Tuesday represent?

C. The supplier's estimated arrival

Tuesday is a provisional supply estimate rather than a workshop or collection commitment.

3. What does Nia promise?

C. A supply-status update Monday afternoon

Nia commits to an update, not to a supply outcome or completed repair.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which statement preserves the supplier information?

A. Arrival is estimated for Tuesday, with shipment unconfirmed

The estimate is provisional and does not establish shipment or collection.

2. Why can Nia not promise Tuesday pickup?

C. Supply, technician scheduling, and completion are not confirmed

The necessary supply and workshop stages remain unresolved in the brief.

3. What should Nia promise in this case?

A. A supply-status update Monday afternoon

The supplied commitment is a status update at the stated time.

4. What does Ben's request establish?

D. His preferred collection date, not an accepted promise

A requested pickup date must remain distinct from a confirmed collection commitment.

05 Conversation answers

Explaining parts and completion delays

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. back order. Turn 2. Back order is the current supply status; the part is not confirmed as immediately available.

2. shipment confirmation. Turn 4. Shipment confirmation is absent, so an actual dispatch must not be implied.

3. Workshop scheduling. Turn 6. Workshop scheduling remains unconfirmed and is a separate stage from the supplier's estimated arrival.

4. pickup request. Turn 8. Pickup request records Ben's preference for Tuesday without making it an accepted collection commitment.

5. supply-status update. Turn 10. Supply-status update is the Monday-afternoon communication Nia actually promises.

6. progress checkpoint. Turn 12. Progress checkpoint identifies an agreed communication point, not a shipment or completion guarantee.

7. collection commitment. Turn 14. Collection commitment requires actual readiness arrangements and is not established by a supplier estimate.

8. order status. Turn 16. Order status records the supply position for the specific job rather than a general parts conversation.

9. estimated arrival. Turn 18. Estimated arrival is the supplier's provisional Tuesday date, not a confirmed delivery or finished vehicle.

10. completion confirmation. Turn 20. Completion confirmation is the later verified status needed before a collection promise can be made.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. order

Clerk: "The part is on back order."

Back order is the current supply status for the required part.

2. Tuesday

Customer: "The supplier estimates arrival on Tuesday."

Tuesday is an estimated arrival date, not a confirmed collection appointment.

3. confirmed

Clerk: "Shipment has not been confirmed."

Shipment remains unverified despite the supplier's estimated arrival date.

4. afternoon

Customer: "The supply update is promised Monday afternoon."

Monday afternoon is the stated communication commitment rather than a guaranteed delivery.

06 Briefing and language checks

Relaying findings and technical terms

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does the note record?

C. A diagnostic trouble code

The technician note records a code without confirming the cause or component fault.

2. What has Tomas assumed?

D. The sensor must need replacement

Tomas has treated the code as proof of a specific replacement need.

3. What should Ava request next?

D. A clearer technician explanation

The missing explanation must come from the technician rather than the advisor's guess.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. A code is recorded, but the cause is not confirmed

The available note records information without establishing a confirmed cause.

2. Which abbreviation is correctly expanded?

D. DTC: diagnostic trouble code

Diagnostic trouble code is the stated full term for DTC.

3. Which sentence invents evidence?

C. Jules tested the sensor and proved it faulty

No sensor-test result or confirmed component fault appears in the supplied facts.

4. Which handoff respects the approval limit?

B. Request clarification before any separate repair proposal

Clarification is needed, and no replacement authorization has been given.

06 Conversation answers

Relaying findings and technical terms

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. diagnostic trouble code. Turn 2. Diagnostic trouble code is the recorded information, not proof that a particular sensor needs replacement.

2. replacement decision. Turn 4. Replacement decision requires support beyond treating the recorded code as a parts-order instruction.

3. assessment note. Turn 6. Assessment note is the available technician record, which contains no supplied sensor-test result.

4. finding. Turn 8. Finding here is limited to the recorded code, not a completed diagnosis or readiness conclusion.

5. component fault. Turn 10. Component fault would attribute an established problem to a particular part, which this note does not do.

6. technician clarification. Turn 12. Technician clarification asks Jules to explain the available evidence rather than having Ava supply a guess.

7. repair authorization. Turn 14. Repair authorization has not been given merely because Tomas asked whether a sensor needs replacement.

8. plain-language explanation. Turn 16. Plain-language explanation makes the note understandable without adding a vehicle-readiness or safety claim.

9. unsupported inference. Turn 18. Unsupported inference identifies the leap from a code to proven sensor failure without dismissing the customer's question.

10. interpretation. Turn 20. Interpretation explains the significance and limits of the information without inventing a diagnosis or approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. code

Advisor: "DTC means diagnostic trouble code."

Code completes the correct full form of the diagnostic abbreviation.

2. confirmed

Customer: "The cause has not been confirmed."

Confirmed is the missing evidential status in the technician note.

3. clarification

Advisor: "I will request technician clarification."

Clarification is the next action needed to explain the limited finding.

4. approved

Customer: "No replacement has been approved."

Approved distinguishes permission from a customer question about the sensor.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the stated invoice total?

A. \$180

The supplied invoice contains \$70 parts plus \$110 labor, totaling \$180.

2. What has Imani misunderstood?

B. She thinks another \$70 parts charge is included in labor

Her concern is an apparent extra parts charge within the labor line.

3. What remains unconfirmed?

A. Vehicle readiness

The service desk has not yet supplied vehicle-readiness confirmation.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which explanation resolves the billing query?

A. \$70 parts plus \$110 labor gives the \$180 total

The supplied bill contains two charges whose sum is exactly \$180.

2. Which statement wrongly infers readiness?

A. The invoice exists, so come and collect now

Invoice creation does not establish the vehicle's collection status.

3. What can Leo say about payment?

A. The supplied facts do not establish payment status

No payment or receipt information is included in the supplied facts.

4. Which request should Leo send?

C. Confirm collection status for job 527

The service desk must verify readiness independently of the invoice explanation.

07 Conversation answers

Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. itemized bill. Turn 2. Itemized bill separates the parts and labor entries so their amounts can be explained individually.

2. invoice total. Turn 4. Invoice total is \$180 because the two stated charges are \$70 and \$110.

3. billing query. Turn 6. Billing query names Imani's request to understand the apparent extra charge without assuming an accusation.

4. parts charge. Turn 8. Parts charge is the \$70 entry, distinct from the \$110 labor entry.

5. collection readiness. Turn 10. Collection readiness has not been confirmed merely because the invoice was issued.

6. billing record. Turn 12. Billing record explains the charges but is not the missing vehicle-handover confirmation.

7. payment status. Turn 14. Payment status is not supplied, so Leo must not infer that the invoice has been paid.

8. readiness check. Turn 16. Readiness check asks the service desk to verify the unresolved collection position.

9. job reference. Turn 18. Job reference connects the collection inquiry and billing conversation to the same service job.

10. handover confirmation. Turn 20. Handover confirmation is the missing readiness information needed before collection arrangements are treated as settled.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. seventy

Advisor: "The parts charge is seventy dollars."

Seventy is the supplied parts entry, not an additional charge within labor.

2. ten

Customer: "The labor charge is one hundred ten dollars."

Ten completes the stated labor amount of one hundred ten dollars.

3. eighty

Advisor: "The two charges total one hundred eighty dollars."

Eighty completes the correct sum of seventy and one hundred ten dollars.

4. unconfirmed

Customer: "Collection readiness is still unconfirmed."

Unconfirmed preserves the missing service-desk status despite the issued invoice.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What does Farah report?

D. The same intermittent rattle two days after service

The brief gives a repeat customer report, not a technical conclusion about its cause.

2. What should Daniel correct?

D. His claim that it cannot be the same issue

The initial dismissal was unsupported because the cause remains unknown.

3. What can Nia do at 15:00?

B. Call to review the report and next arrangements

The stated commitment is a review call rather than a repair or coverage guarantee.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which apology is most appropriate?

A. I am sorry I dismissed your report; the cause has not been established

The response owns the unsupported dismissal without inventing a diagnosis or remedy.

2. Which note preserves the evidence?

B. Customer reports same intermittent rattle two days after service

The note retains timing and attribution without adding an unestablished technical conclusion.

3. What does 15:00 refer to?

B. Nia's review call

The brief identifies 15:00 as the time of the service lead's call.

4. Which response answers the coverage question accurately?

D. Coverage needs review; the callback does not decide it

Neither the cause nor coverage has been determined; a callback and an apology do not establish either.

08 Conversation answers

Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. unsupported dismissal.** Turn 2. Unsupported dismissal describes Daniel's rejection of the report without an established cause.
- 2. reported recurrence.** Turn 4. Reported recurrence preserves Farah's account without turning it into a confirmed technical diagnosis.
- 3. service history.** Turn 6. Service history keeps the earlier visit available during review of the repeat report.
- 4. underlying cause.** Turn 8. Underlying cause remains unknown even after Daniel corrects his inappropriate response.
- 5. service lead.** Turn 10. Service lead identifies the named person who can review the report and discuss next arrangements.
- 6. callback.** Turn 12. Callback is the promised telephone review, not a vehicle drop-off or repair appointment.
- 7. Warranty coverage.** Turn 14. Warranty coverage is unresolved and must not be promised or denied without the relevant review.
- 8. follow-up record.** Turn 16. Follow-up record carries the repeat concern, earlier correction, and coverage question into the next conversation.
- 9. repeat concern.** Turn 18. Repeat concern is the same intermittent rattle reported again two days after the earlier service.
- 10. communication repair.** Turn 20. Communication repair corrects the mishandled response while keeping diagnosis, coverage, and later arrangements unresolved.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. dismissed

Advisor: "I should not have dismissed your report."
Dismissed identifies the unsupported response that Daniel must explicitly correct.

2. intermittent

Customer: "The rattle is still intermittent."
Intermittent preserves the reported pattern instead of changing it to a constant sound.

3. 15:00

Advisor: "Nia can call at 15:00."
15:00 is the stated review-call time, not a repair completion time.

4. unknown

Customer: "Warranty coverage remains unknown."
Unknown preserves the unresolved coverage position without promising or denying protection.

09 Conversation answers

Read the whole tire description

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. nominal section width. Turn 2. The 205 marking is nominal section width in millimeters; it is not the tread depth, circumference, or rim diameter.

2. aspect ratio. Turn 4. The 55 marking expresses sidewall height as fifty-five percent of nominal section width, not as a fifty-five-millimeter height.

3. radial construction. Turn 6. R identifies radial construction in this size designation; it does not mean radius or rear position on the vehicle.

4. rim diameter. Turn 8. Sixteen denotes the compatible rim diameter in inches, not the outside diameter of the tire; the size code mixes dimension types and units.

5. load index. Turn 10. Ninety-one is an index for a load-capacity rating, not a literal ninety-one-kilogram load; the applicable rating information and vehicle requirements must be checked.

6. speed rating. Turn 12. V is the speed-rating symbol in the service description; it is not a recommended driving speed or proof that this tire is approved for the vehicle.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 225

Customer: The nominal section width is 225 millimeters.

The first number gives nominal section width, not wheel diameter or tread depth.

2. 45

Advisor: The aspect ratio is 45 percent.

Forty-five is the sidewall-height percentage of nominal section width, not a millimeter dimension.

3. 17

Customer: The rim diameter is 17 inches.

The number after R states rim diameter in inches; R itself denotes radial construction.

4. unapproved

Advisor: Fitment remains unapproved .

Reading the code does not establish that this specification meets the actual vehicle requirements.

Background reading: [Michelin: tire size, construction, load index, speed rating, and pressure markings](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Charge added is not wall energy

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

- 1. state of charge.** Turn 2. The requested increase is eighty minus twenty, or sixty percentage points, rather than a full empty-to-full charge of the sixty-kilowatt-hour usable battery.
- 2. usable capacity.** Turn 4. The case gives sixty kilowatt-hours of usable capacity and a linear percentage assumption; multiplying by 0.60 gives thirty-six kilowatt-hours stored.
- 3. AC input limit.** Turn 6. The compatible point offers 7.4 kW but this vehicle accepts at most 7.2 kW AC; the fictional constant-input calculation therefore uses 7.2 kW.
- 4. wall energy.** Turn 8. Thirty-six kilowatt-hours stored divided by 0.90 efficiency requires forty kilowatt-hours from the wall in the supplied model.
- 5. charging efficiency.** Turn 10. Ninety percent means stored energy equals 0.90 times wall energy; solve by division, and do not apply a second loss allowance.
- 6. energy charge.** Turn 12. Forty billed kilowatt-hours at \$0.25 each gives a ten-dollar energy-only charge, excluding any other fees by the case's stated terms.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

- 1. 20**
Owner: The increase in stored battery energy is 20 kWh.
The fifty-percentage-point increase is half of forty usable kilowatt-hours, giving twenty stored.
- 2. 25**
Advisor: Required wall energy in the model is 25 kWh.
Twenty divided by 0.80 equals twenty-five kilowatt-hours, including the supplied loss assumption.
- 3. five**
Owner: Modeled charging time is five hours.
Twenty-five wall kilowatt-hours divided by constant five-kilowatt wall input gives five hours.
- 4. six**
Advisor: The energy-only charge is six dollars.
Twenty-five kilowatt-hours multiplied by \$0.24 equals six dollars, not the cost of stored energy alone.

10

Background reading: [US Department of Energy AFDC: charging capacity, power, and timing factors](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Minutes of angle are not decimals

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. angular minutes. Turn 2. The marks represent sixtieths of a degree, not hundredths; six angular minutes equals 0.10 decimal degree and twelve equals 0.20.

2. decimal degrees. Turn 4. Correct conversion gives 0.10 plus 0.20 = 0.30 decimal degrees; adding incorrectly copied hundredths would give a false 0.18 result.

3. total toe. Turn 6. The stated range applies to the sum across the front axle, not to each wheel independently; total toe is positive 0.30 degree here.

4. sign convention. Turn 8. The fictional report explicitly defines positive as toe-in; the plus signs must remain attached instead of being dropped or interpreted from another report's convention.

5. camber. Turn 10. Camber is a separate alignment angle; the negative thirty-minute entry converts to -0.50 degree and must not be added to the toe figures.

6. before readings. Turn 12. The values are initial readings and the AFTER column is blank; a report title does not establish adjustment, final results, or completed verification.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 0.15

Advisor: Left toe is +0.15 decimal degrees.

Nine divided by sixty equals 0.15 degree; writing 0.09 would confuse minutes with hundredths.

2. 0.05

Technician: Right toe is +0.05 decimal degrees.

Three divided by sixty equals 0.05 degree, preserving the supplied positive sign.

3. 0.20

Advisor: Total toe is +0.20 decimal degrees.

0.15 plus 0.05 equals 0.20 degree, equivalent to twelve angular minutes.

4. unrecorded

Technician: The final result is unrecorded in this extract.

The AFTER column is blank; converting the initial values does not establish a completed adjustment or final verification.

11

Background reading: [Hunter Engineering: alignment measurement units, formats, and total toe](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Capturing the customer's concern

Confirm the vehicle: Which of the two cars is booked today?

Ask for the existing description: How have you described the sound you noticed?

Avoid inventing a cause: You have not identified what causes it.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

Acknowledge the expectation: I understand that you expected the work to start at eight.

Avoid a one-hour promise: Completion by 09:00 has not been confirmed.

Record the method: I will keep phone as the contact method.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Explaining estimates and approval limits

Name the present service: The \$95 charge is for the assessment.

Read back the charge: You are authorizing the \$95 assessment.

Avoid a false inclusion: The assessment charge is not a repair package.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Handing the concern to the technician

Open with the identifier: This handoff is for job card 208.

State the assessment limit: You have not reproduced the concern.

Exclude assumed extra work: No repair authorization is recorded.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Explaining parts and completion delays

State the current supply position: The part for job 315 is on back order.

Separate dispatch and arrival: A dispatch confirmation would not itself mean the part has arrived.

Keep completion separate: Part arrival is not the same as completed work.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Relaying findings and technical terms

Expand the abbreviation: DTC stands for diagnostic trouble code.

Explain the limit: It does not confirm the cause.

Preserve the uncertainty: The cause remains unconfirmed in this note.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

Invite the query: Which line would you like me to explain?

Name the first amount: The parts charge is \$70.

Acknowledge the confusion: I can see why the layout prompted that question.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

Acknowledge the return: You are reporting the same intermittent rattle.

Withdraw the claim: I should not have made that statement.

Avoid reversing into certainty: I cannot say the previous work definitely failed either.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acknowledgment give a specific acknowledgment	68
actuator identify the actuator	50
additional work seek approval for additional work	24
angular minute convert angular minutes to decimal degrees	6
apology make a direct apology	68
appointment clarify what the appointment covers	14
approval limit preserve the approval limit	23
approval record update the approval record	24
arithmetic check the arithmetic	59
assessment authorization confirm assessment authorization	32
assessment fee explain the assessment fee	23
assessment note read the assessment note	51
assessment only state assessment only	23
assessment scope confirm the assessment scope	23
authorization record the authorization	23
authorization boundary state the authorization boundary	33
availability window record the availability window	15
back order confirm back-order status	41
balance due verify the balance due	60
billing query resolve a billing query	59
billing record correct the billing record	60
booking reference confirm the booking reference	5
booking terms clarify the booking terms	15
cabin locate the cabin concern	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

callback confirm the callback	69
callback number verify the callback number	14
circuit identify the relevant circuit	50
collection commitment distinguish a collection commitment	42
collection readiness verify collection readiness	60
collection time confirm the collection time	14
commitment readback give a commitment readback	15
communication repair begin communication repair	69
complaint ownership clarify complaint ownership	69
completion confirmation obtain completion confirmation	42
completion time distinguish completion time	14
component fault avoid inventing a component fault	51
component replacement propose component replacement	24
concern history retain the concern history	33
concern readback give a concern readback	6
confirmed cause avoid inventing a confirmed cause	33
confirmed cause distinguish a confirmed cause	51
confirmed date distinguish a confirmed date	42
confirmed finish distinguish a confirmed finish	15
contact method confirm the contact method	14
contact note include the contact note	33
contact window preserve the contact window	32
control module identify the control module	50
correction put the correction on record	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

cost commitment clarify the cost commitment	24
coverage determination avoid promising a coverage determination	69
credit adjustment distinguish a credit adjustment	60
customer concern capture the customer concern	5
customer consent confirm customer consent	24
customer-reported label the concern customer-reported	32
decision boundary explain the decision boundary	24
delay notice give a delay notice	42
delivery confirm delivery	41
dependency explain the dependency	42
diagnostic evidence explain the diagnostic evidence	51
diagnostic hypothesis distinguish a diagnostic hypothesis	33
diagnostic outcome avoid guaranteeing a diagnostic outcome	24
diagnostic time distinguish diagnostic time	23
diagnostic trouble code record a diagnostic trouble code	50
discount identify an authorized discount	59
dispatch distinguish dispatch from arrival	41
drop-off confirm the drop-off time	14
duplicate charge investigate a suspected duplicate charge	59
estimated arrival state the estimated arrival	41
estimated finish qualify the estimated finish	15
fault tracing distinguish fault tracing from code reading	51
finding relay the limited finding	51
finding status clarify the finding status	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

follow-up record	update the follow-up record	69
freeze-frame data	interpret freeze-frame data	50
frequency	clarify the reported frequency	6
goodwill offer	avoid inventing a goodwill offer	69
handoff readback	request a handoff readback	33
handover confirmation	obtain handover confirmation	60
hatchback	identify the blue hatchback	5
installation	distinguish installation from delivery	42
intake	distinguish intake from workshop work	14
intermittent	describe an intermittent concern	6
intermittent rattle	retain the intermittent rattle description	32
intermittent symptom	describe an intermittent symptom	68
internal handoff	give an internal handoff	32
interpretation	separate a record from its interpretation	51
invoice	explain the invoice	59
invoice date	verify the invoice date	60
invoice total	confirm the invoice total	59
itemized bill	read the itemized bill	59
itemized quote	provide an itemized quote	23
job card	prepare the job card	6
job identifier	state the job identifier	32
job reference	match the job reference	60
labor charge	distinguish the labor charge	24
labor charge	explain the labor charge	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

lead time clarify the lead time	41
line item identify each line item	59
live data distinguish live data	50
load index verify the load index	5
malfunction indicator lamp report an illuminated lamp	50
model confirm the model	5
next arrangements discuss next arrangements	69
next communication plan the next communication	33
no-charge work distinguish no-charge work from a review call	69
noise concern describe the noise concern	33
non-reproduction distinguish non-reproduction from resolution	33
not reproduced retain not-reproduced status	32
odometer record the odometer reading	5
on-board diagnostics refer to on-board diagnostics	50
order status update the order status	41
overnight parking note overnight parking	6
part allocation verify part allocation	41
parts availability check parts availability	41
parts charge identify the parts charge	23
parts charge distinguish the parts charge	59
parts clerk contact the parts clerk	42
payment status check payment status	60
pending code distinguish a pending code	50
phone preference record the phone preference	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

pickup request	record the pickup request	42
plain-language explanation	provide a plain-language explanation	51
preferred channel	preserve the preferred channel	32
progress checkpoint	set a progress checkpoint	42
progress report	give a progress report	15
provisional date	retain the provisional date	42
rattle	describe the reported rattle	6
readiness check	request a readiness check	60
rear	locate the sound at the rear	6
receipt	distinguish a receipt from an unpaid invoice	60
release arrangements	confirm release arrangements	60
repair authorization	distinguish repair authorization	32
repair authorization	obtain repair authorization	51
repair proposal	present the repair proposal	23
repair record	consult the repair record	68
repair scope	separate the repair scope	23
repeat concern	acknowledge a repeat concern	68
replacement decision	support a replacement decision	51
reported conditions	preserve the reported conditions	6
reported recurrence	preserve the reported recurrence	68
reported trigger	preserve the reported trigger	33
reproduced concern	record whether the concern was reproduced	32
return complaint	record the return complaint	68
review appointment	clarify the review appointment	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

same symptom distinguish the same symptom from the same cause	68
scan tool identify the scan-tool record	50
schedule clarification give a schedule clarification	15
scope readback give a scope readback	24
sensor distinguish a sensor from its circuit	50
separate approval obtain separate approval	23
service advisor brief the service advisor	5
service contract distinguish a service contract from a warranty	69
service desk check with the service desk	60
service history review the service history	68
service inclusion confirm service inclusions	24
service interval check the service interval	5
service lead refer the report to the service lead	69
shipment confirmation await shipment confirmation	41
state of charge distinguish state of charge from capacity	5
stated terms follow the stated terms	24
status update provide a status update	14
stored code identify a stored code	50
subtotal distinguish a subtotal from the stated total	59
supplier estimate qualify the supplier estimate	41
supplier follow-up arrange supplier follow-up	42
supply-status update provide a supply-status update	41
symptom description retain the symptom description	6
tax line avoid inventing a tax line	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

technician assessment distinguish a technician assessment	6
technician clarification request technician clarification	51
technician slot verify the technician slot	14
timing expectation acknowledge the timing expectation	15
tire aspect ratio read the tire aspect ratio	5
total toe read total toe	6
transport arrangement discuss a transport arrangement	15
turnaround avoid promising an unverified turnaround	15
unavailable interval record the unavailable interval	32
uncertain completion explain uncertain completion	42
underlying cause avoid assuming the underlying cause	68
unpriced repair distinguish an unpriced repair	24
unsupported dismissal withdraw an unsupported dismissal	68
unsupported inference correct an unsupported inference	51
update deadline meet the update deadline	14
vehicle identification confirm vehicle identification	5
vehicle identification number confirm the vehicle identification number	5
waiting appointment verify a waiting appointment	15
warranty coverage check warranty coverage	69
work queue distinguish the work queue	15
workshop handover complete the workshop handover	33
workshop scheduling confirm workshop scheduling	41
workshop start confirm the workshop start	14
written estimate review the written estimate	23

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Automotive Service Technicians and Mechanics.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for customer communication, workshop records, maintenance, and repair roles. Technical procedures are not reproduced. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Federal Trade Commission. Auto Repair Basics.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for distinguishing diagnostic charges, estimates, parts, labor, and repair records. The fictional charges are not market prices or universal legal rules. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Bosch Car Service. Car Diagnostics.

[Open the original source](#)

Reference for distinguishing fault-code information from confirmed diagnosis and replacement decisions. No testing or repair instructions are supplied. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Federal Trade Commission. Auto Warranties and Auto Service Contracts.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for checking actual coverage and terms rather than promising them. The cases offer no warranty determination or jurisdiction-specific advice. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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